



US012404078B2

(12) **United States Patent**
Torrison et al.

(10) **Patent No.:** **US 12,404,078 B2**

(45) **Date of Patent:** ***Sep. 2, 2025**

(54) **SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR
IMPLEMENTING CAP CLOSURE FOR
CARBONATED AND OXYGEN SENSITIVE
BEVERAGES**

(71) Applicant: **G3 Enterprises, Inc.**, Modesto, CA
(US)

(72) Inventors: **Miriam Torrison**, Modesto, CA (US);
John Cunningham, Tracy, CA (US);
Scott DeJong, Ripon, CA (US)

(73) Assignee: **G3 Enterprises, Inc.**, Modesto, CA
(US)

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

This patent is subject to a terminal dis-
claimer.

(21) Appl. No.: **17/592,229**

(22) Filed: **Feb. 3, 2022**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

US 2022/0153481 A1 May 19, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 17/066,252, filed on
Oct. 8, 2020, which is a continuation of application
No. 14/608,016, filed on Jan. 28, 2015, now Pat. No.
10,815,035.

(60) Provisional application No. 61/932,701, filed on Jan.
28, 2014.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
B65D 41/14 (2006.01)
B65D 41/04 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **B65D 41/145** (2013.01); **B65D 41/045**
(2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

CPC B65D 41/045; B65D 7/36; B65D 43/0212;
B65D 1/0253; B65D 1/0246

USPC 215/341, 349
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

3,211,316 A * 10/1965 Fischer B65D 41/12
215/328

4,111,323 A 9/1978 Ichinose et al.

4,462,502 A 7/1984 Luenser et al.

5,673,809 A 10/1997 Ohmi et al.

(Continued)

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

CN 101891031 A 11/2010
EP 0263699 A2 4/1988

(Continued)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

U.S. Appl. No. 14/608,016 (now U.S. Pat. No. 10,815,035), filed
Jan. 28, 2015 (Oct. 27, 2020), System and Method for Implementing
Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages
(EJG-013), Torrison.

(Continued)

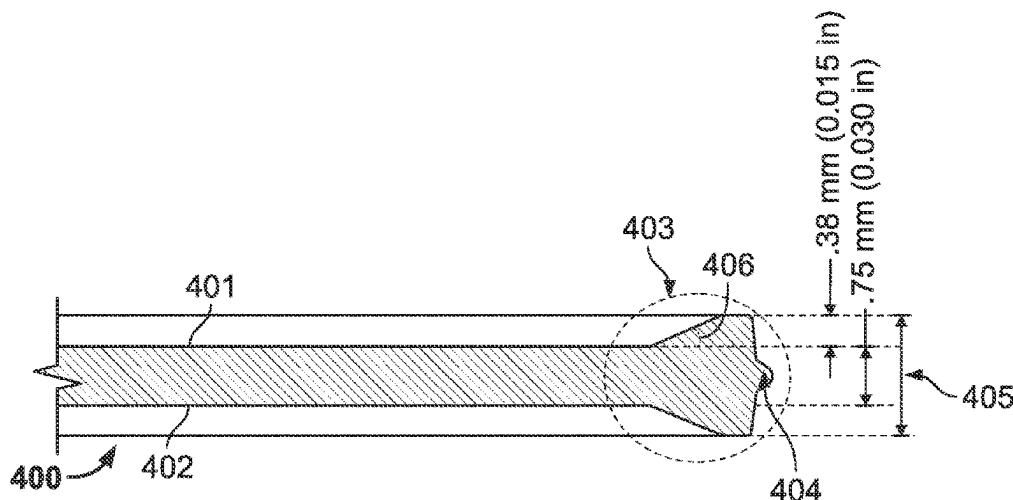
Primary Examiner — Jeffrey R Allen

(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — Dentons US LLP

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A system and method for implementing a cap closure for a
carbonated beverage is disclosed. According to one embodi-
ment, an apparatus includes a cap liner having an outer lip
and an inner portion. The cap liner is symmetric about a
central plane of the inner portion. The outer lip includes an
outer nub extending radially outward.

18 Claims, 36 Drawing Sheets



(56)

References Cited**U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS**

5,829,608	A	11/1998	Clerget	
6,082,566	A	7/2000	Yousif et al.	
6,139,931	A	10/2000	Finkelstein et al.	
6,595,395	B2 *	7/2003	Jourdin	B65D 83/38 222/321.9
6,866,926	B1	3/2005	Smelko et al.	
6,902,075	B2	6/2005	O'Brien et al.	
7,798,359	B1	9/2010	Marsella	
8,703,265	B2	4/2014	Thorstensen-Woll et al.	
2002/0012808	A1	1/2002	Ishizaki et al.	
2002/0162818	A1 *	11/2002	Williams	B65D 41/3447 215/349
2003/0222046	A1 *	12/2003	Schenck	B65D 41/0407 215/347
2004/0191445	A1	9/2004	Baranowski et al.	
2007/0007229	A1	1/2007	Yousif	
2008/0073309	A1	3/2008	Nakajima et al.	
2009/0026166	A1	1/2009	Druitt	
2009/0123766	A1	5/2009	Peck	
2009/0208729	A1	8/2009	Allegaert et al.	
2010/0213193	A1	8/2010	Helmlinger et al.	
2012/0067842	A1	3/2012	Keller	
2012/0111758	A1	5/2012	Lo	
2012/0118764	A1	5/2012	Valus et al.	
2013/0161282	A1	6/2013	Peck	
2016/0052678	A1	2/2016	Hanafusa et al.	

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

FR	1226696	A	7/1960
FR	1249847	A	1/1961
FR	1279992	A	12/1961
FR	2821064	A1	8/2002
GB	675236	A	7/1952

GB	696980	A	9/1953
GB	769259	A	3/1957
WO	WO-2004070410	A1	8/2004
WO	WO-2006113000	A2	10/2006

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

U.S. Appl. No. 17/066,252, filed Oct. 8, 2020, System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages (EJG-013C1), Torrison.

U.S. Appl. No. 17/592,241, filed Feb. 3, 2022, System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages (EJG-013C2), Torrison.

U.S. Appl. No. 17/872,263, filed Jul. 25, 2022, System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages (EJG-013C4), Torrison.

"GPI-1680 Roll-On Finish Compatible With Stel Capsules Technical Bulletin", Glass Packaging Institute, www.gpi.org, Jun. 15, 2005.

Buntinx, Mieke, et al., Evaluation of the Thickness and Oxygen Transmission Rate Before and After Thermoforming Mono- and Multi-layer Sheets into Trays with Variable Depth; Polymers ISSN 2073-4360; www.mdpi.com/journal/polymers.

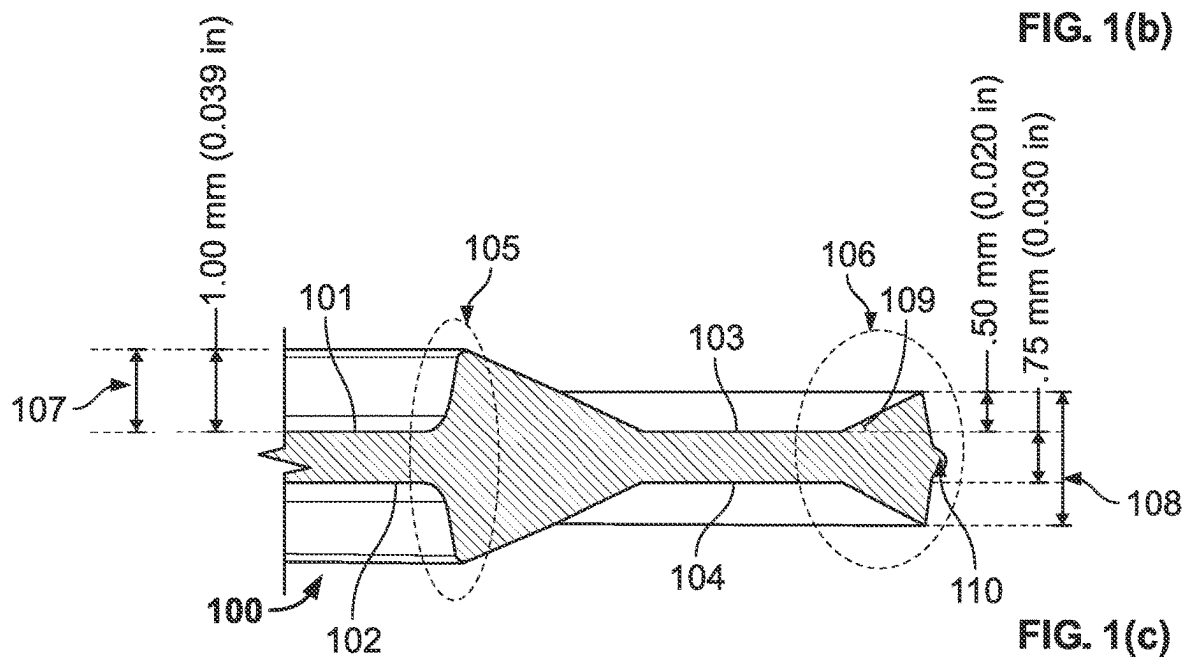
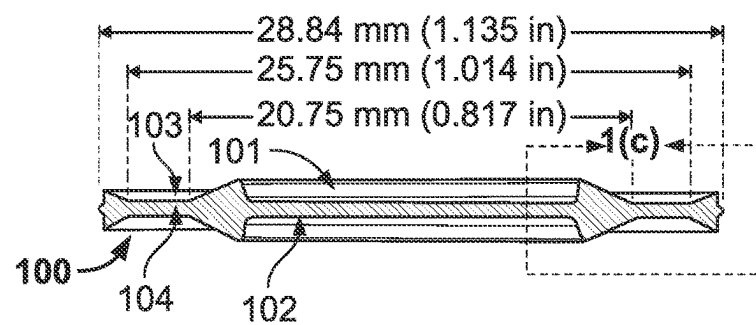
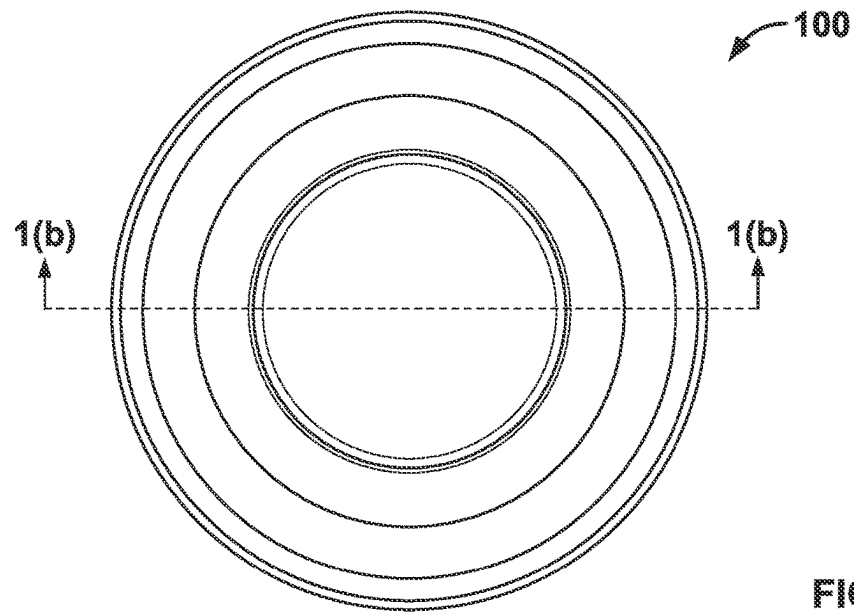
Evergreen, The barrier performance of common plastic film, www.evergreen-packaging.com.

International Search Report issued Feb. 22, 2013 in corresponding PCT Application No. PCT/US2012/71444 filed Dec. 21, 2012, inventor, Peck, James.

International Search Report issued May 11, 2015 in corresponding PCT Application No. PCT/US2015/013346 filed Jan. 28, 2015, inventor(s) Torrison, Miriam, et al.

Supplementary European Search report issued Aug. 25, 2017 in corresponding EP Application No. EP15744075, filed Jul. 27, 2016, Inventor(s) Torrison, Miriam, et al.

* cited by examiner



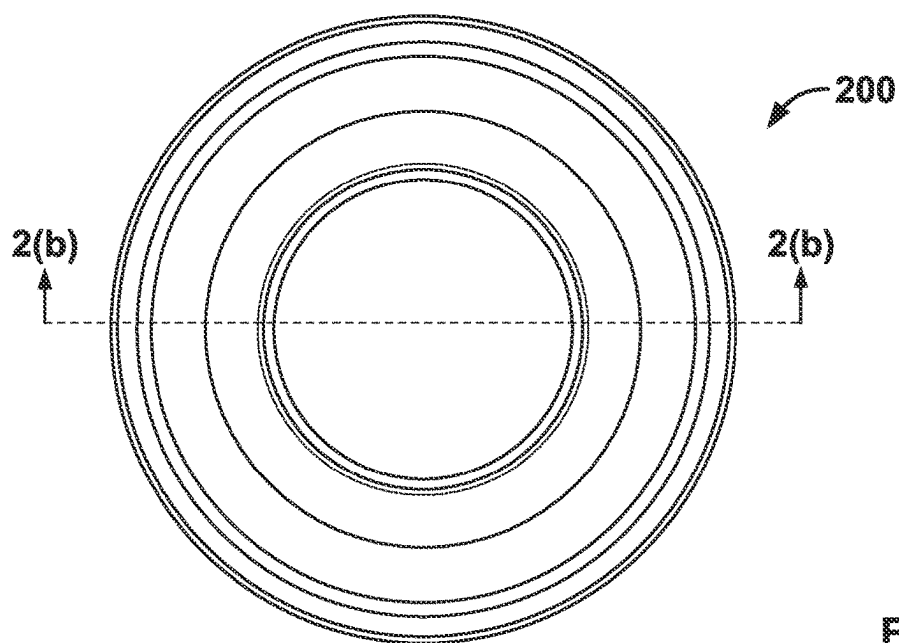


FIG. 2(a)

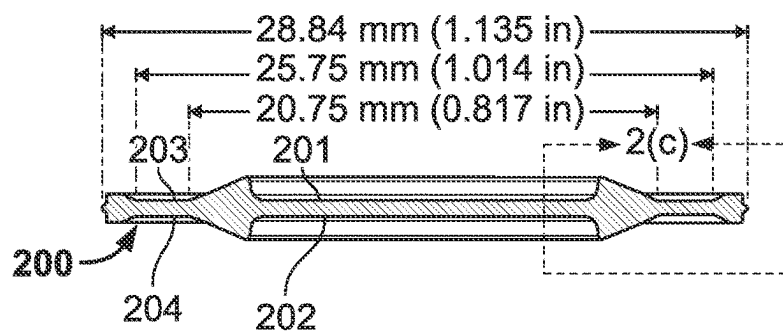


FIG. 2(b)

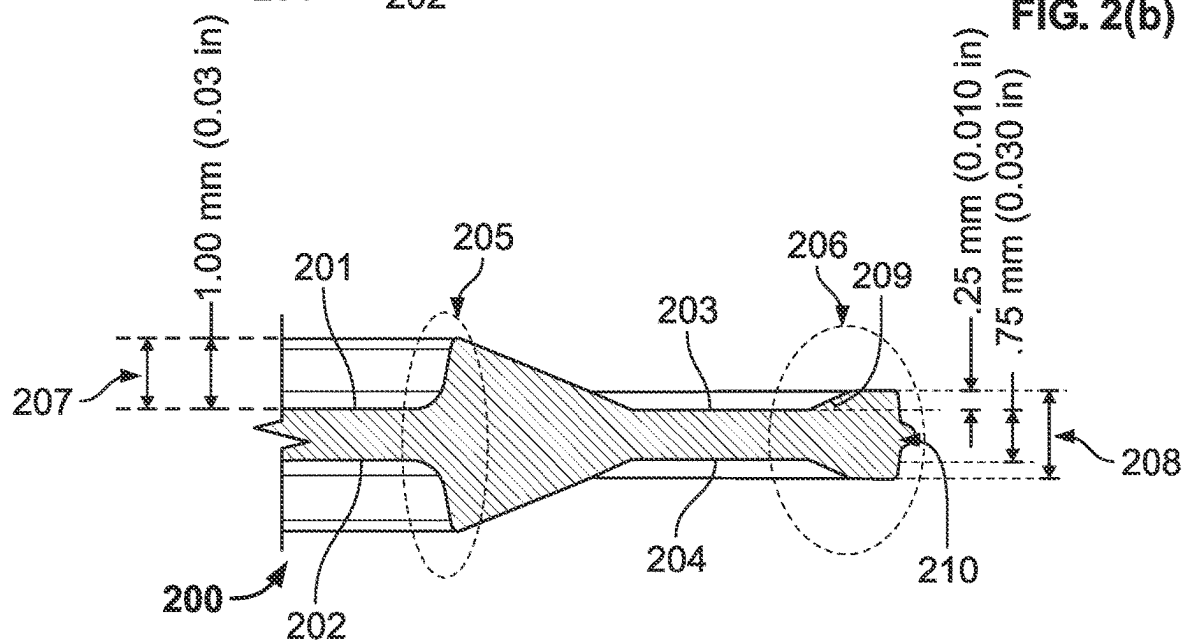


FIG. 2(c)

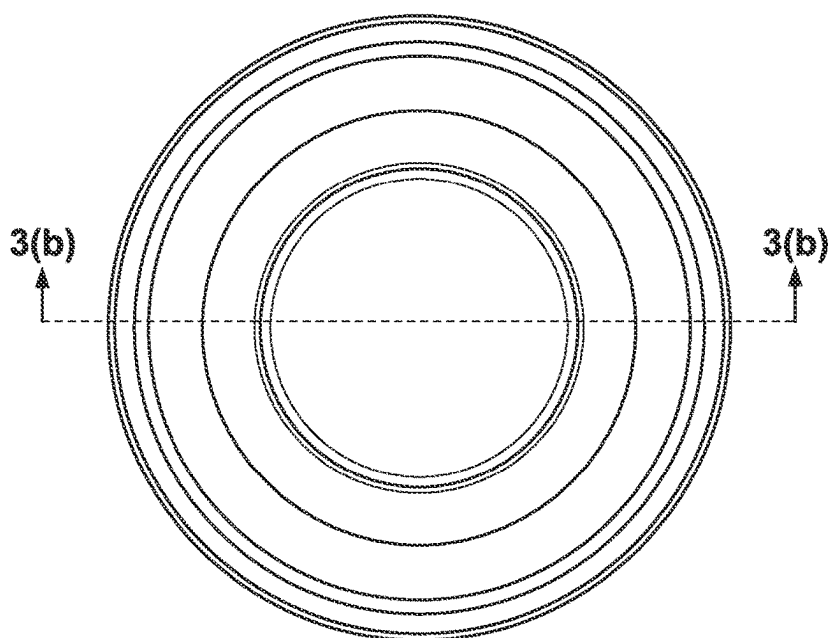


FIG. 3(a)

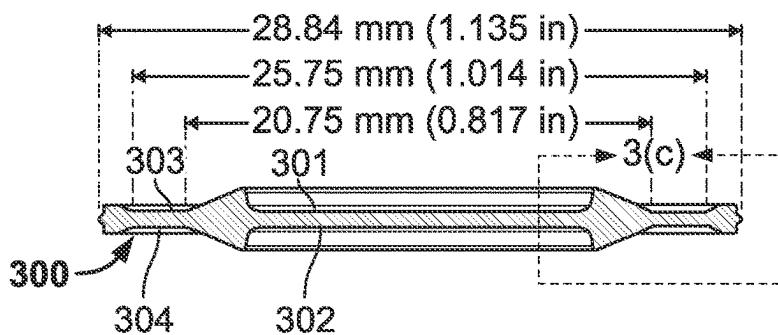


FIG. 3(b)

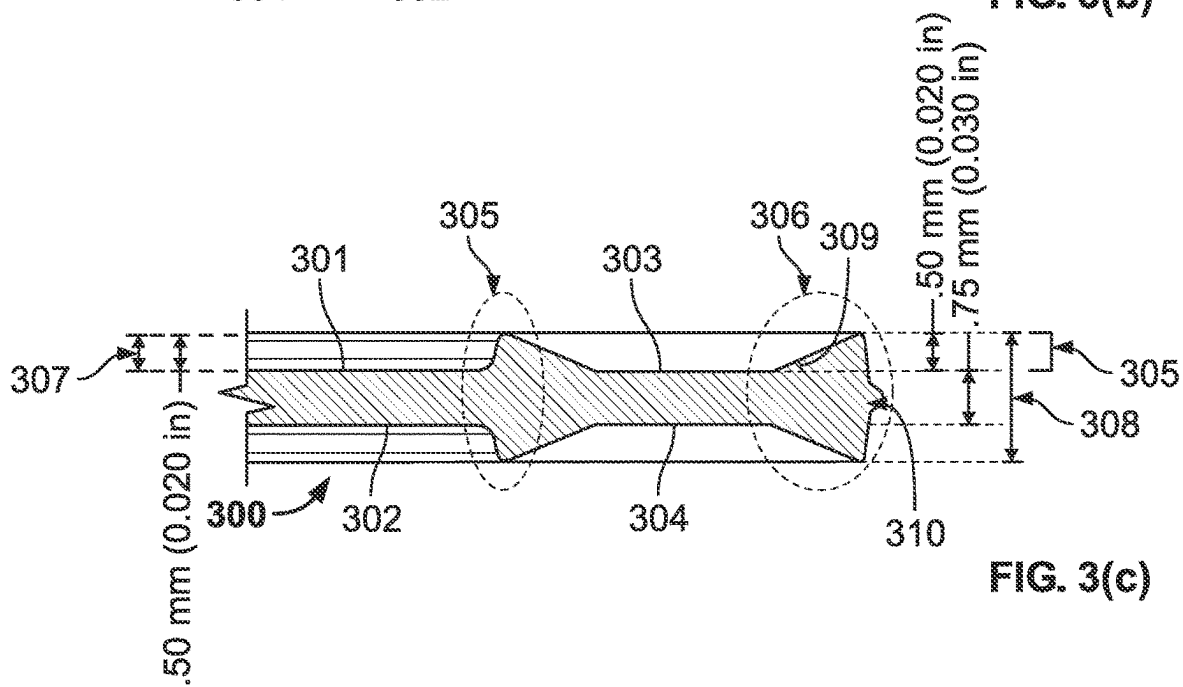


FIG. 3(c)

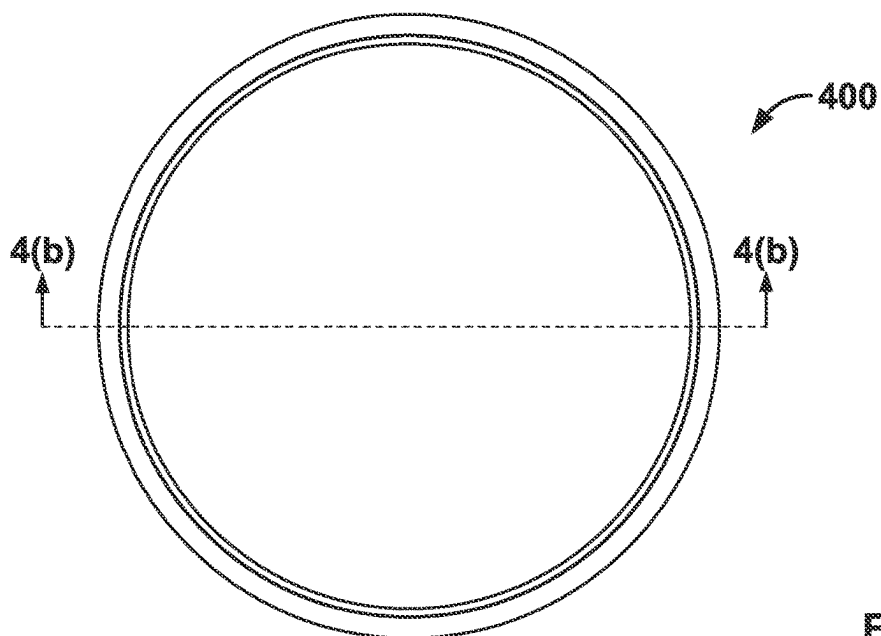


FIG. 4(a)

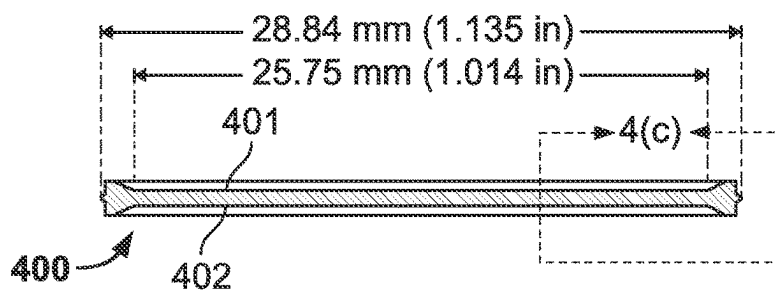


FIG. 4(b)

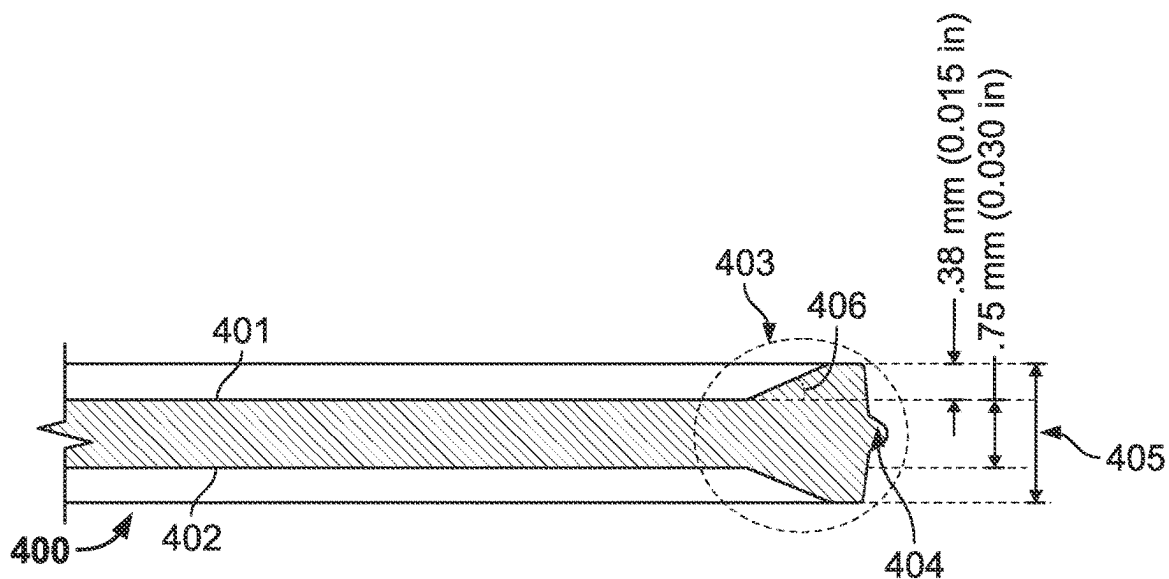


FIG. 4(c)

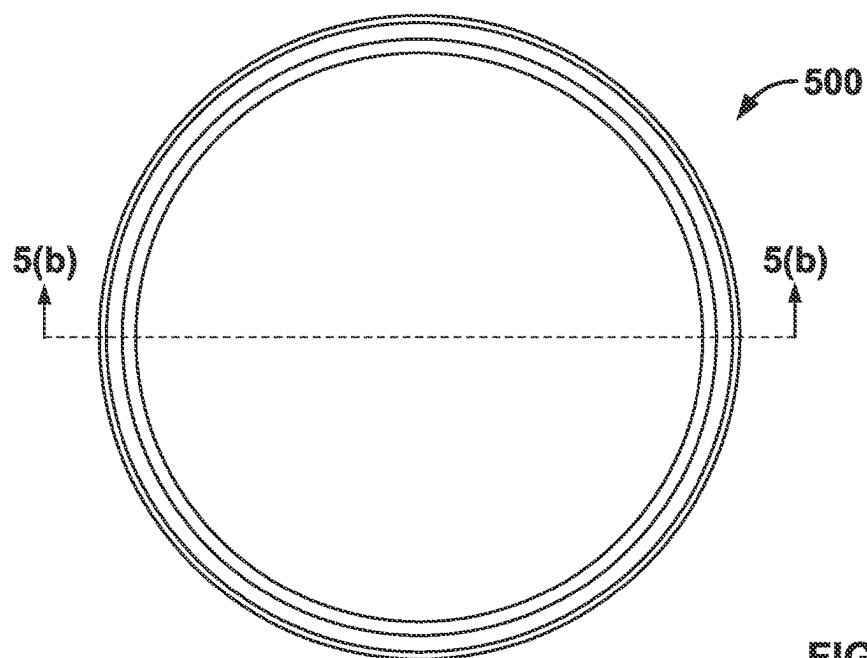


FIG. 5(a)

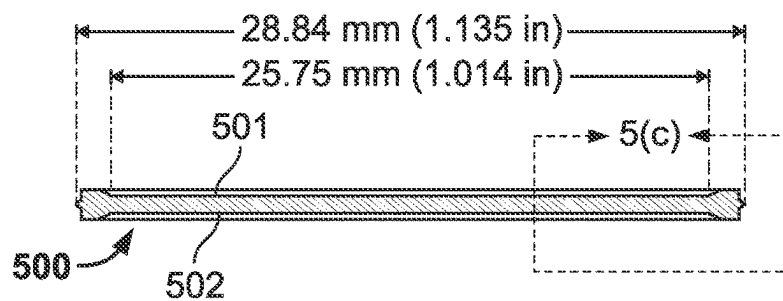


FIG. 5(b)

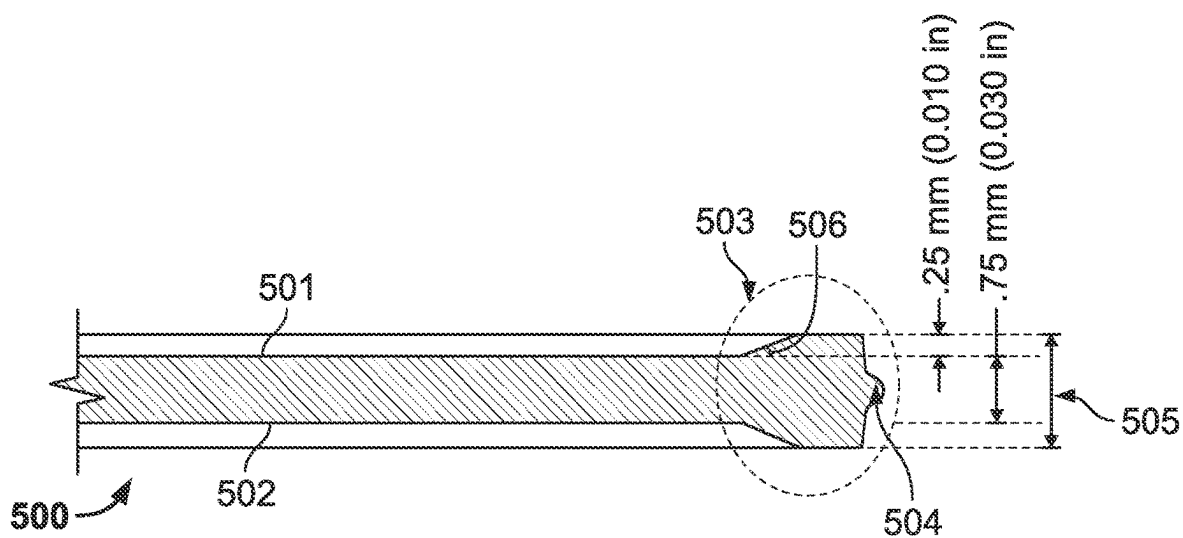


FIG. 5(c)

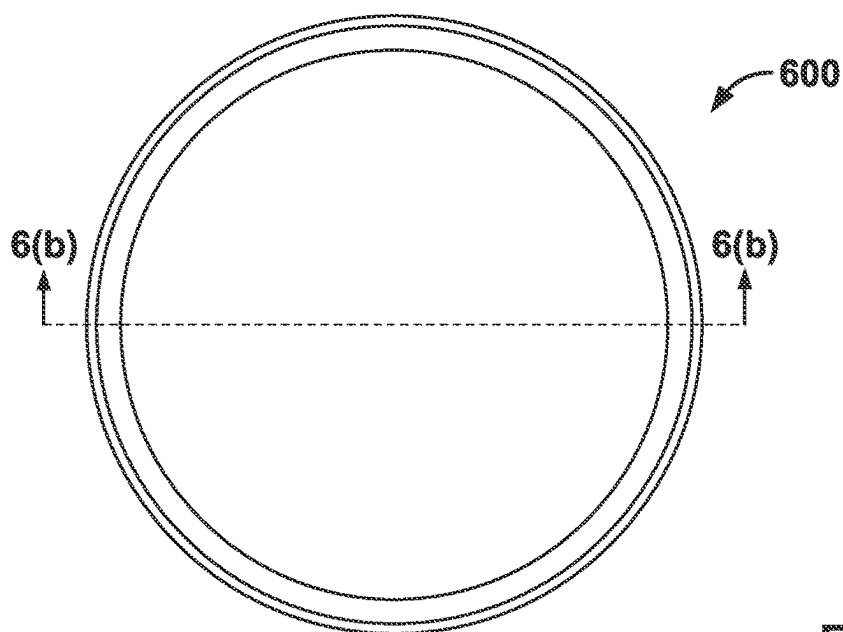


FIG. 6(a)

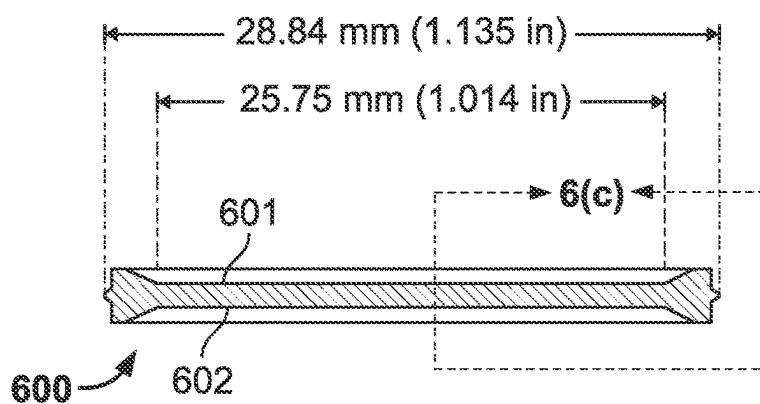


FIG. 6(b)

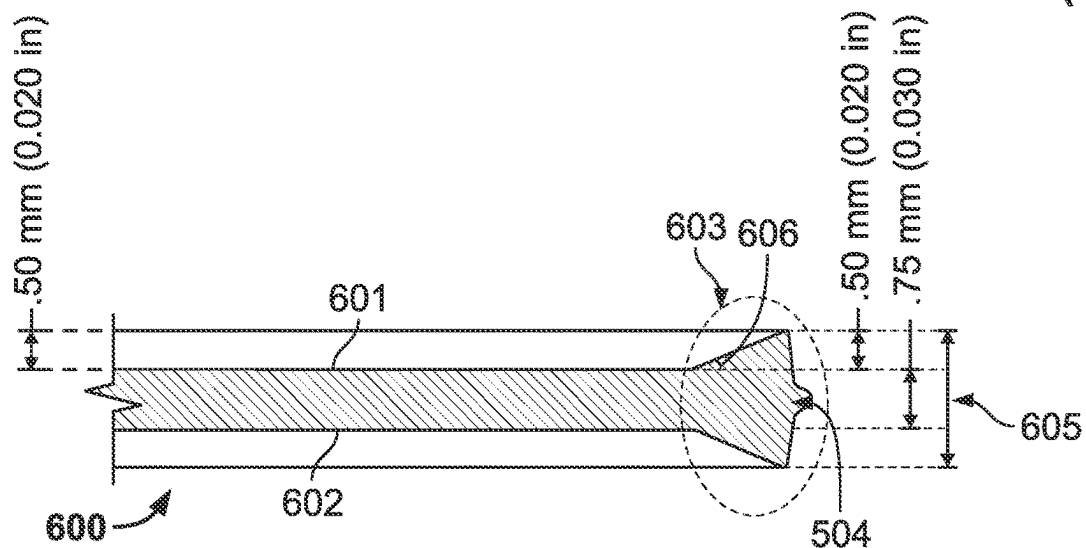


FIG. 6(c)

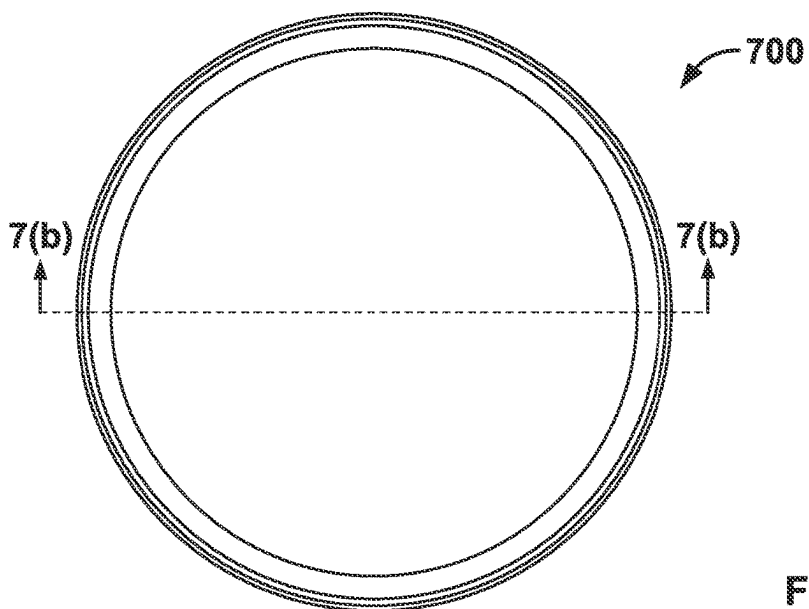


FIG. 7(a)

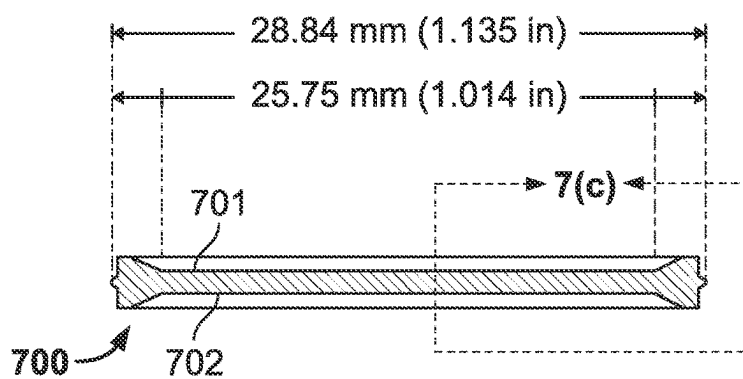


FIG. 7(b)

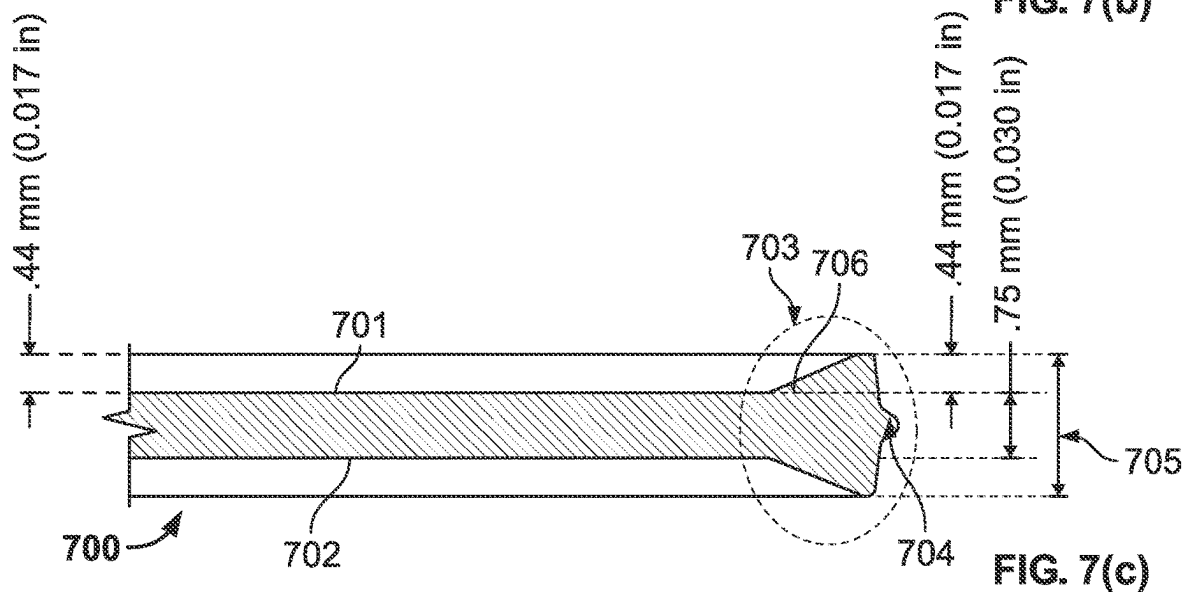


FIG. 7(c)

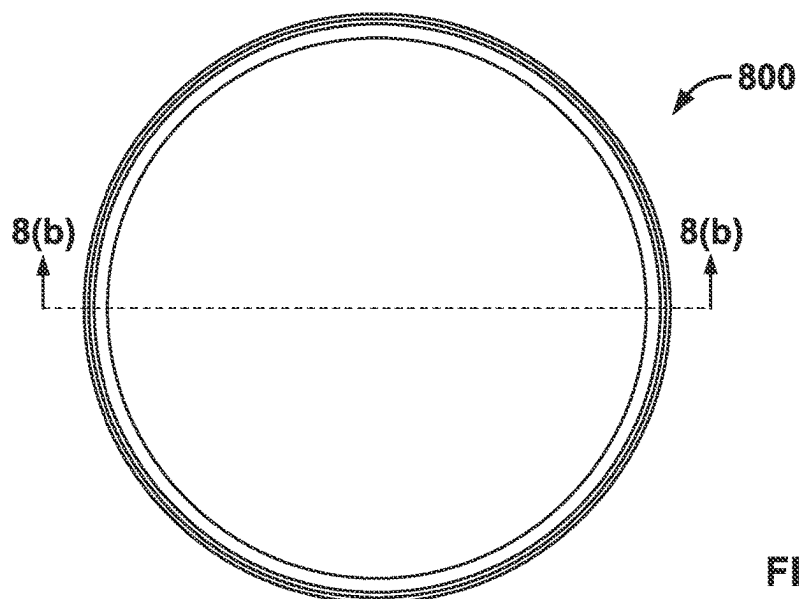


FIG. 8(a)

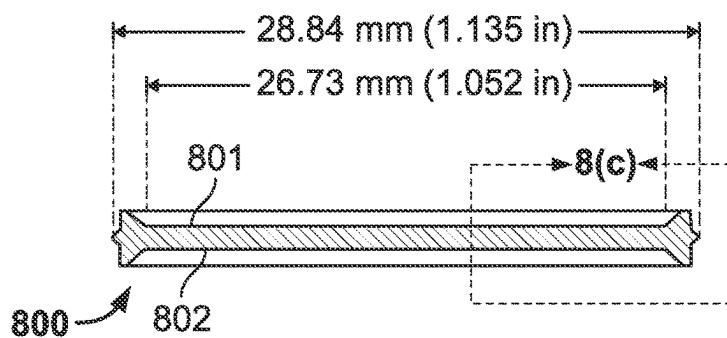


FIG. 8(b)

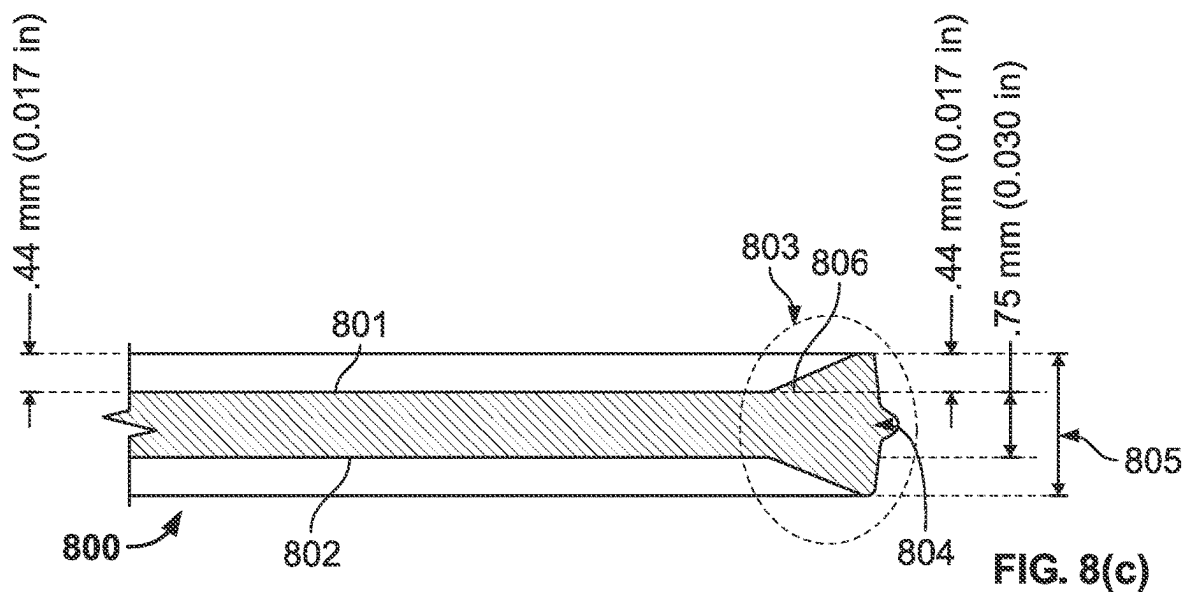


FIG. 8(c)

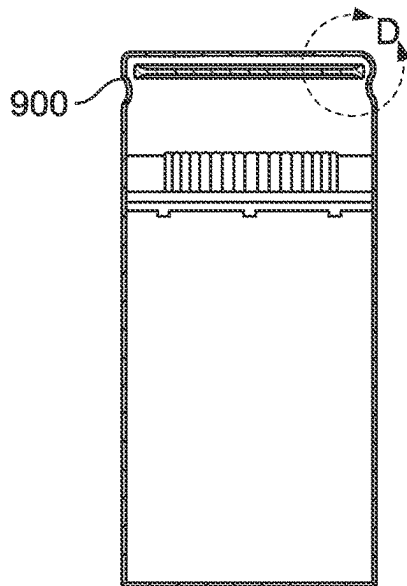


FIG. 9(a)

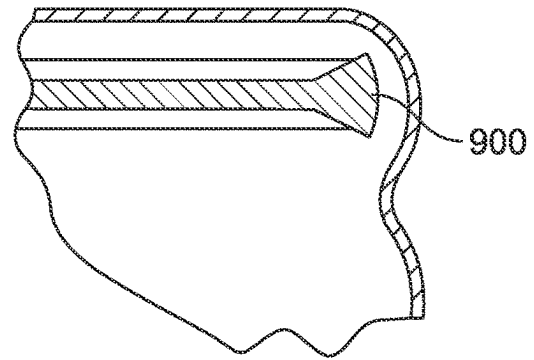


FIG. 9(b)

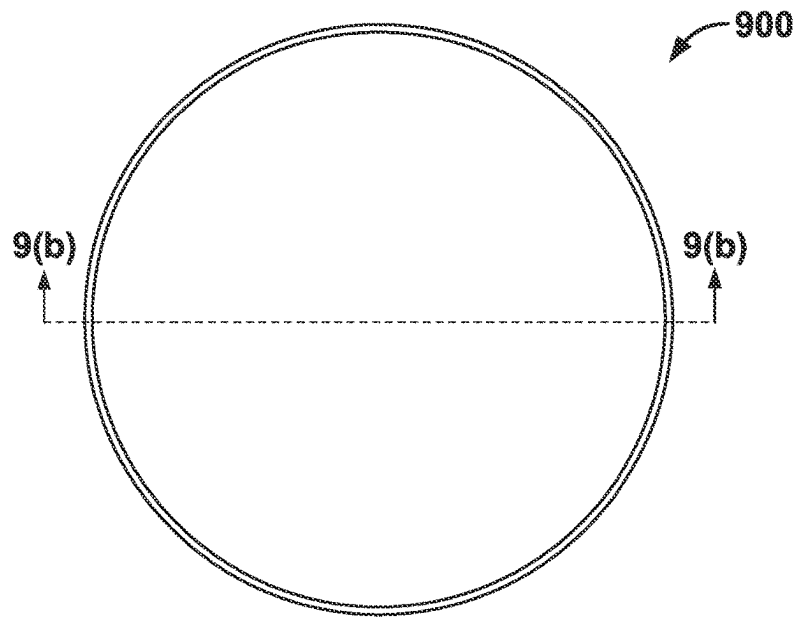


FIG. 9(c)

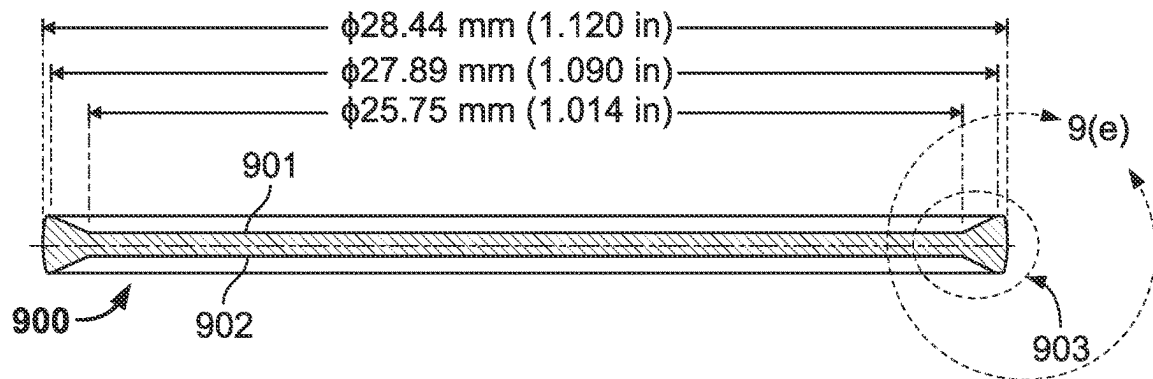


FIG. 9(d)

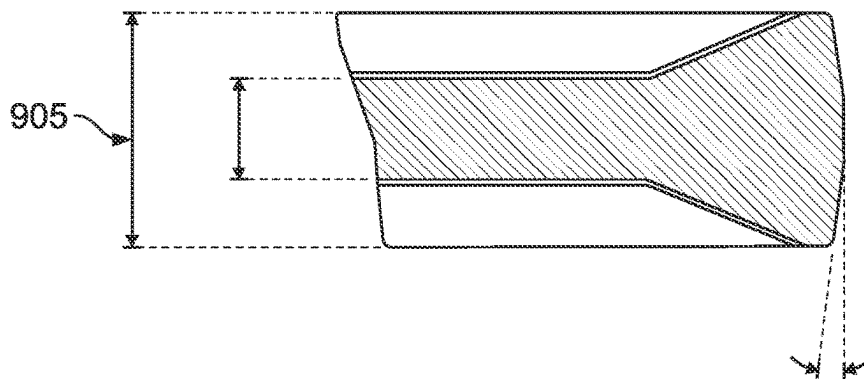


FIG. 9(e)

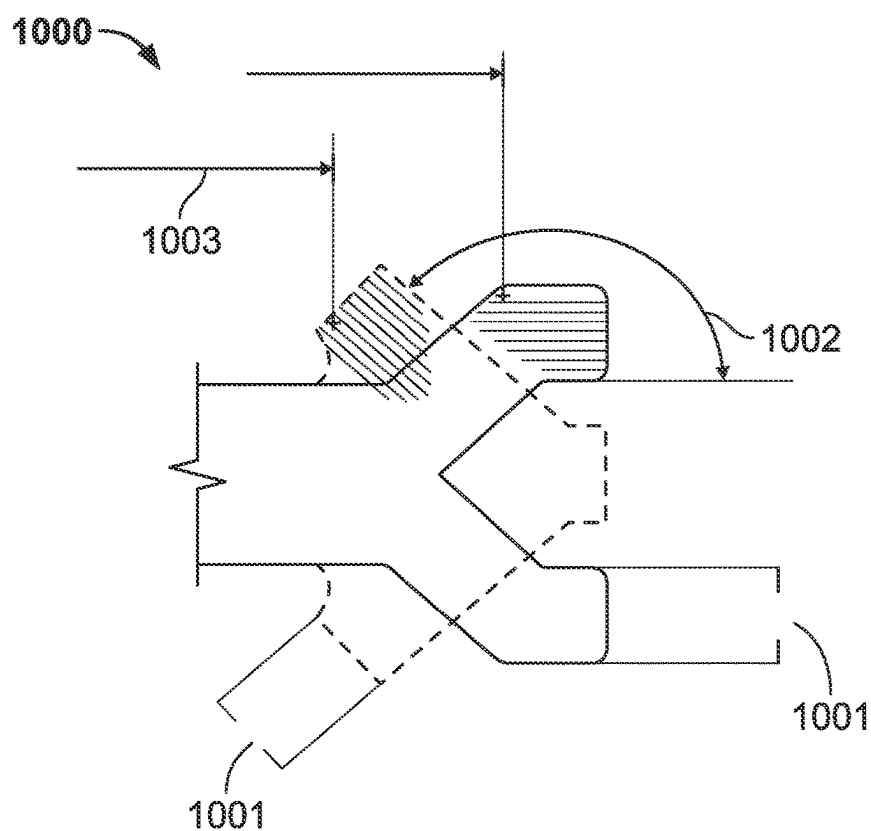


FIG. 10(a)

1004

Trial #	Lip Structure Angle (degrees)	Lip Structure Thickness (in)	Lip Diameter from Baseline (in)
1	0	0.012	-0.01
2	0	0.016	0
3	140	0.008	0
4	70	0.012	0
5	35	0.008	-0.02
6	105	0.016	-0.01
7	140	0.012	-0.02

FIG. 10(b)

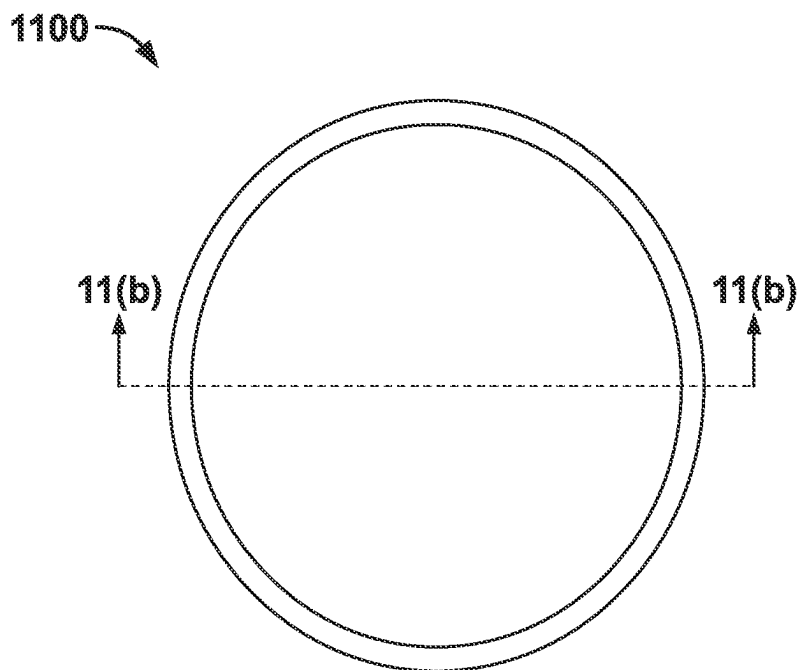


FIG. 11(a)

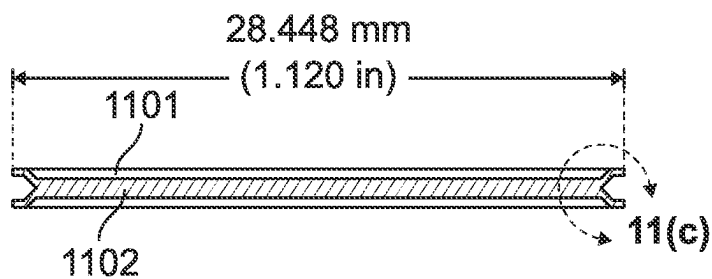


FIG. 11(b)

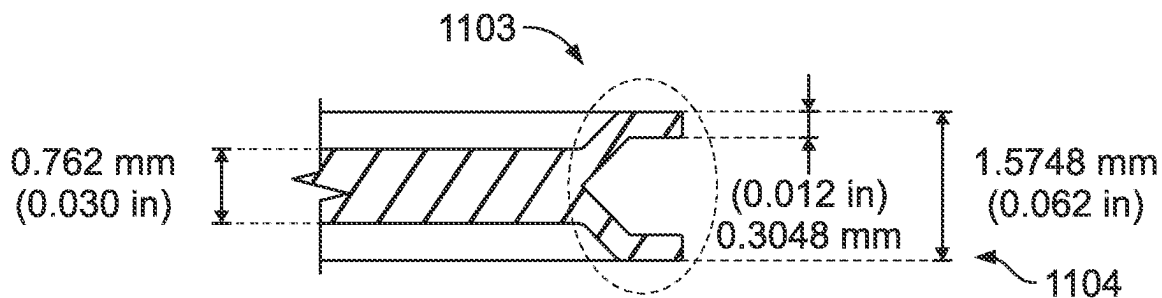


FIG. 11(c)

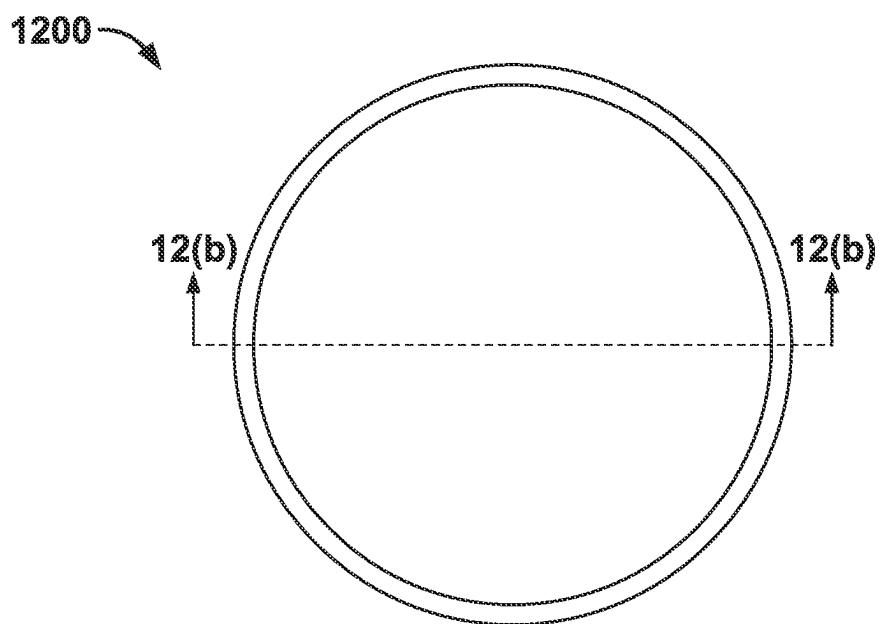


FIG. 12(a)

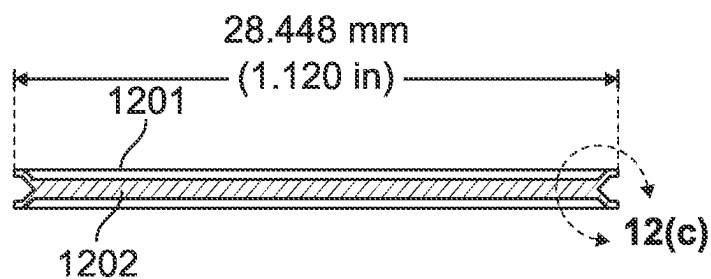


FIG. 12(b)

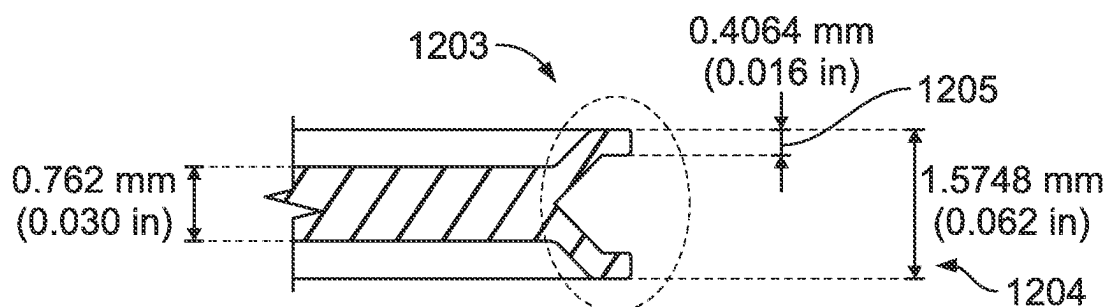


FIG. 12(c)

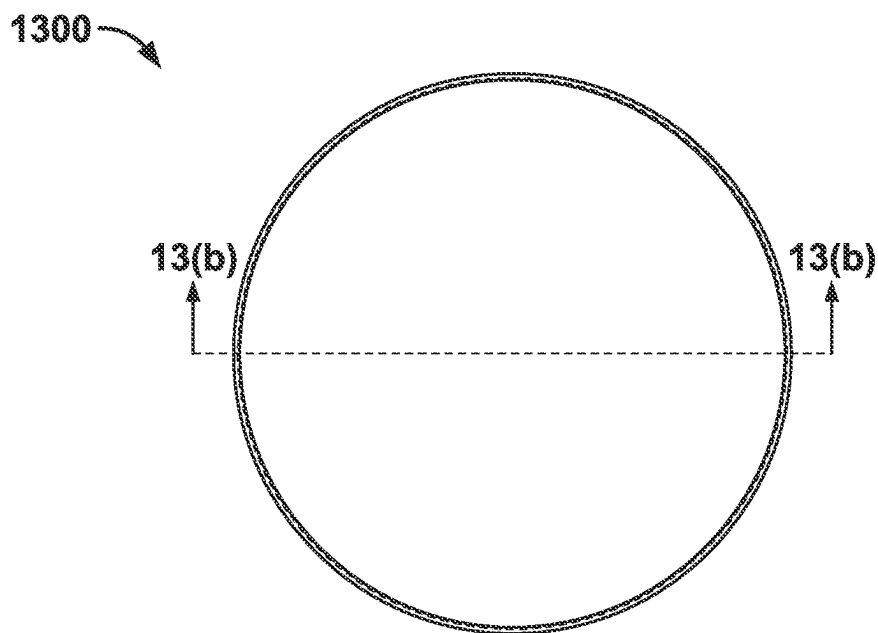


FIG. 13(a)

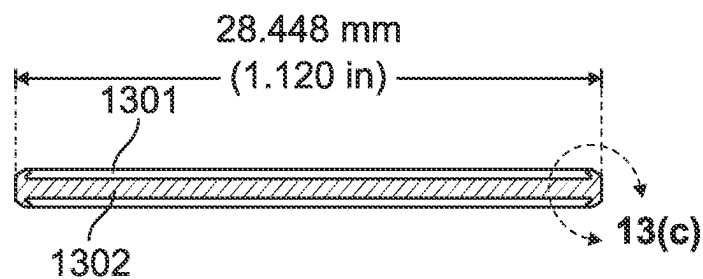


FIG. 13(b)

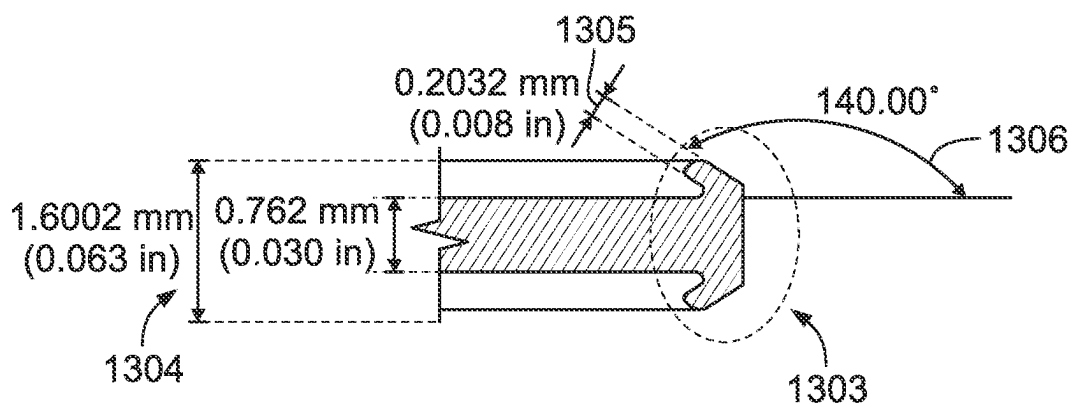


FIG. 13(c)

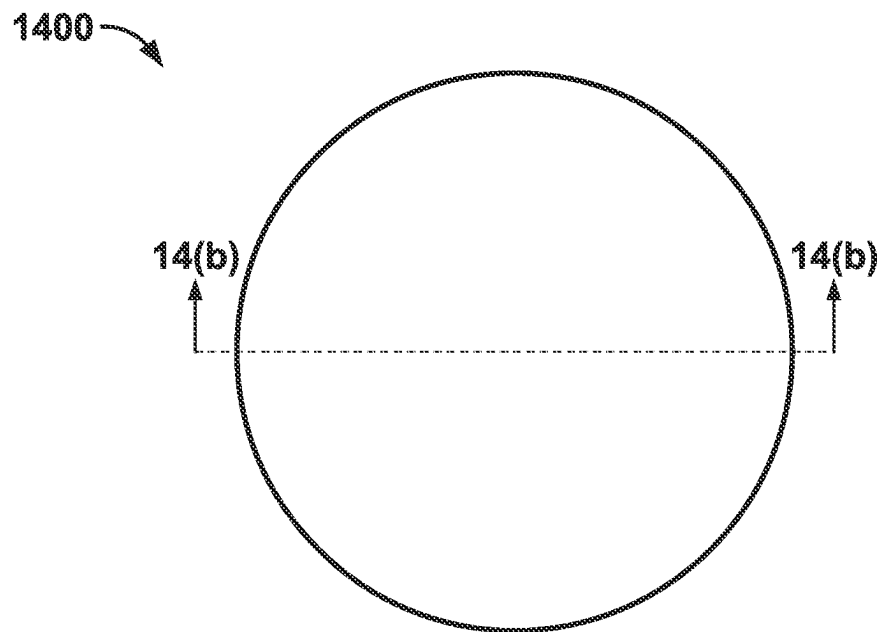


FIG. 14(a)

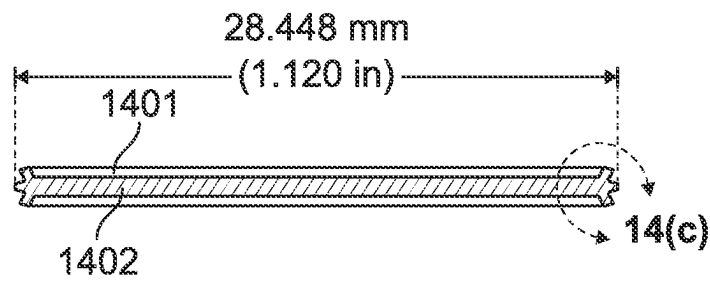


FIG. 14(b)

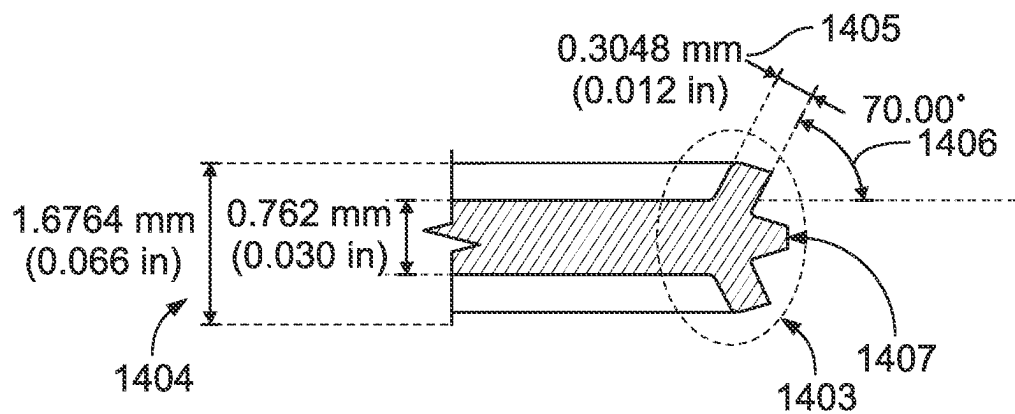


FIG. 14(c)

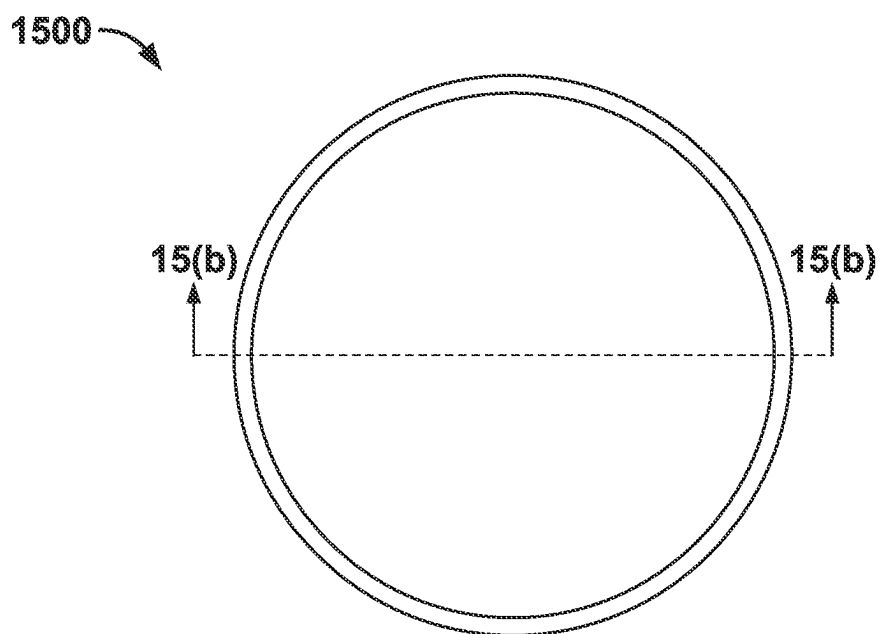


FIG. 15(a)

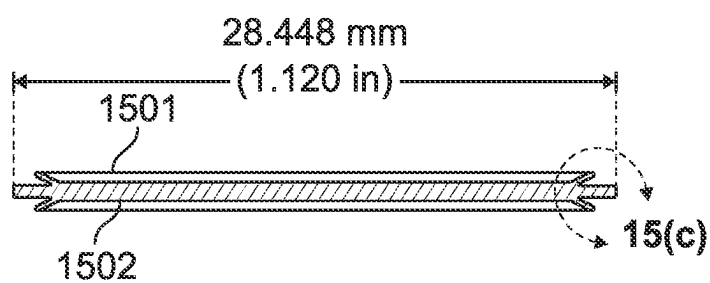


FIG. 15(b)

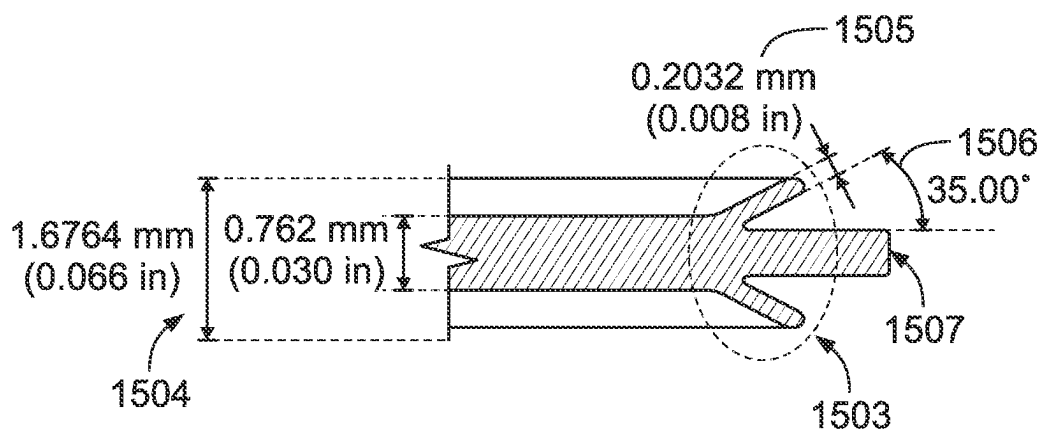


FIG. 15(c)

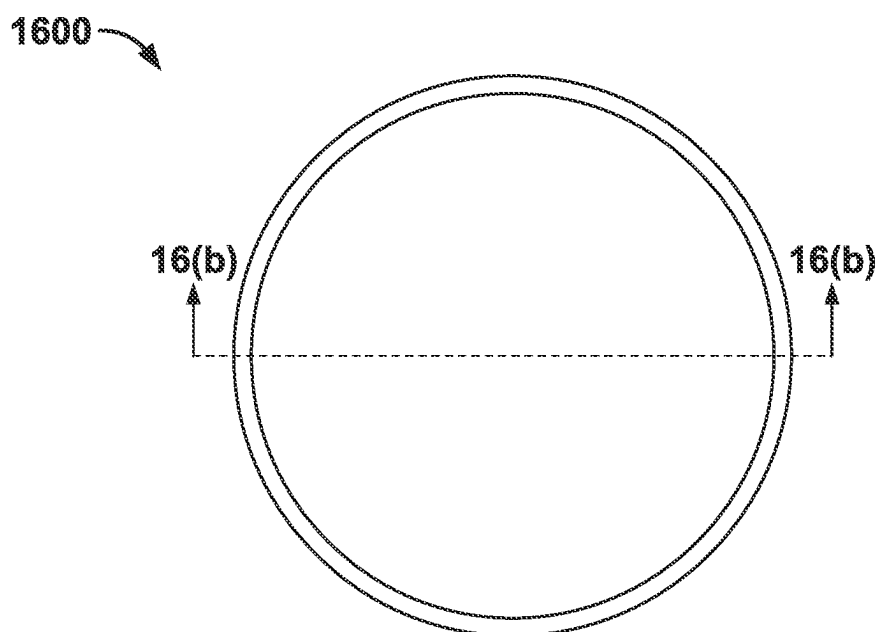


FIG. 16(a)

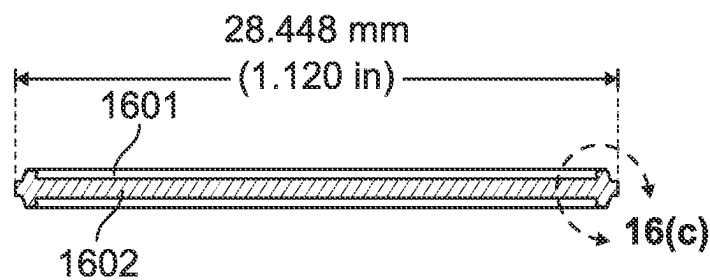


FIG. 16(b)

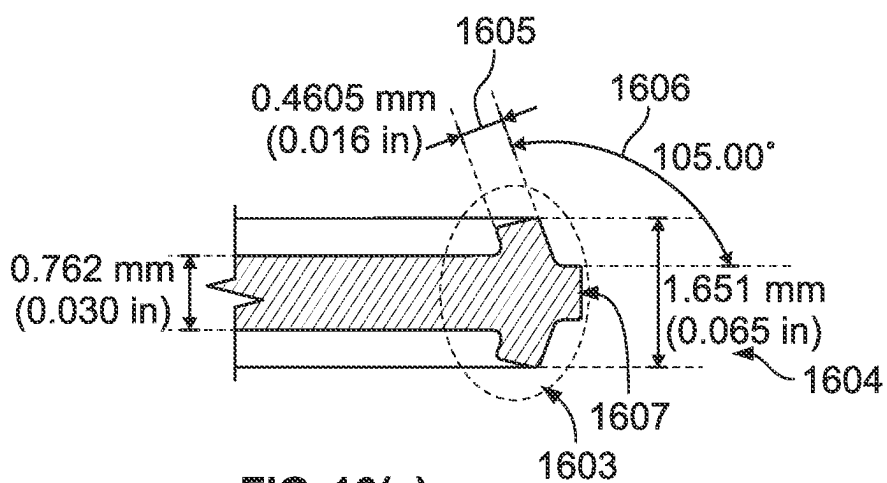


FIG. 16(c)

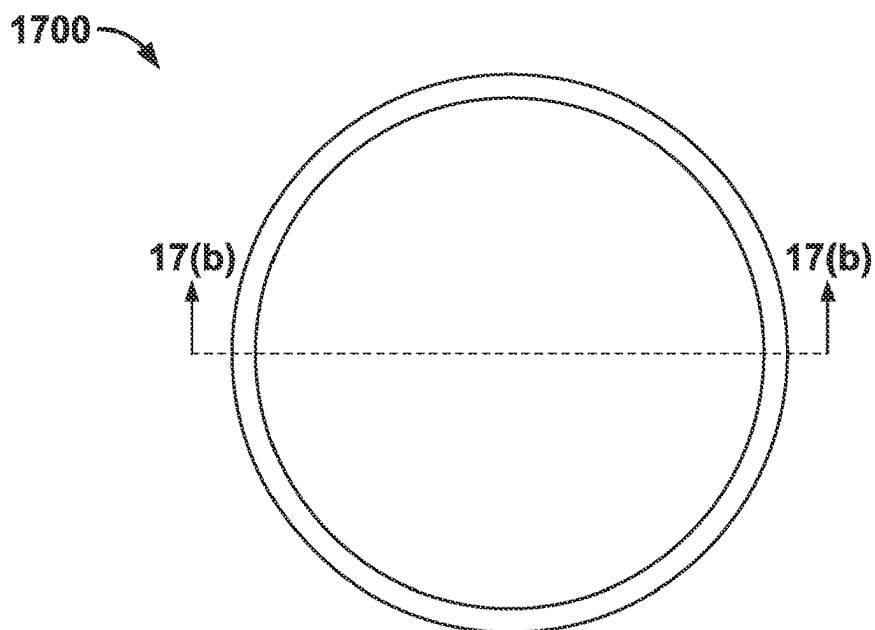


FIG. 17(a)

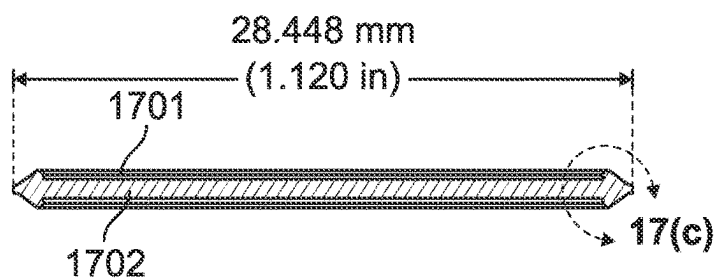


FIG. 17(b)

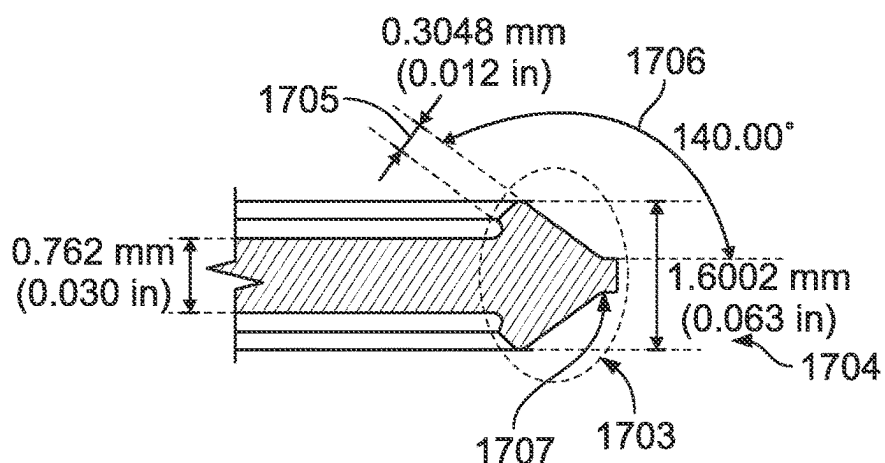


FIG. 17(c)

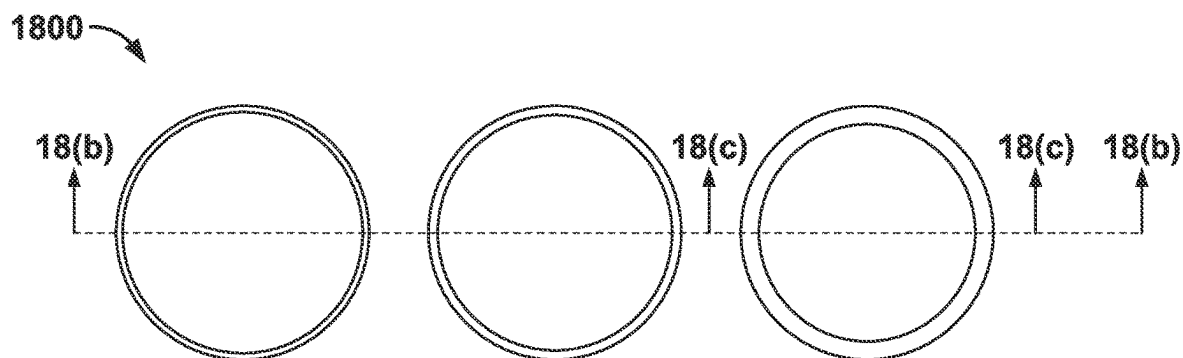


FIG. 18(a)

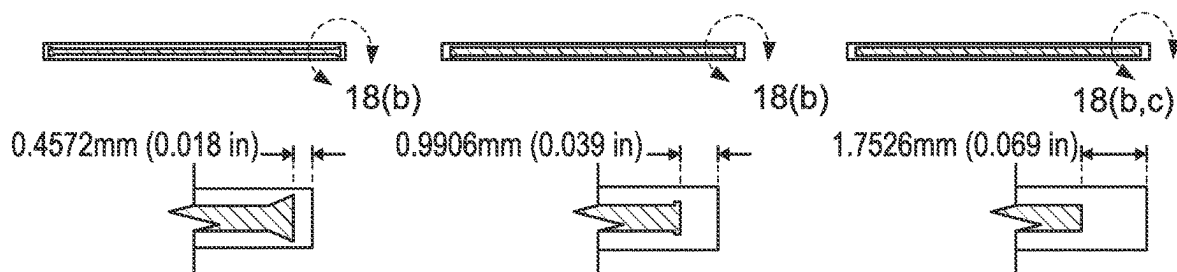


FIG. 18b

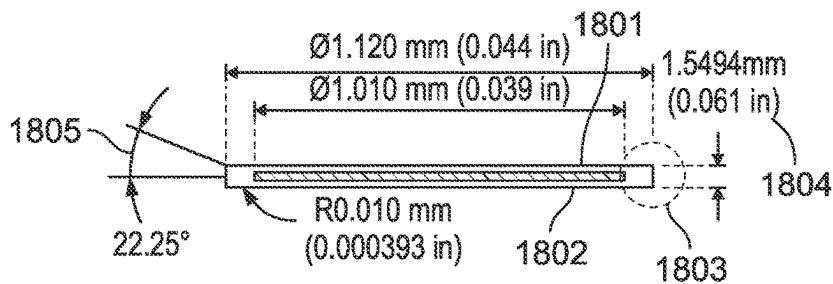


FIG. 18c

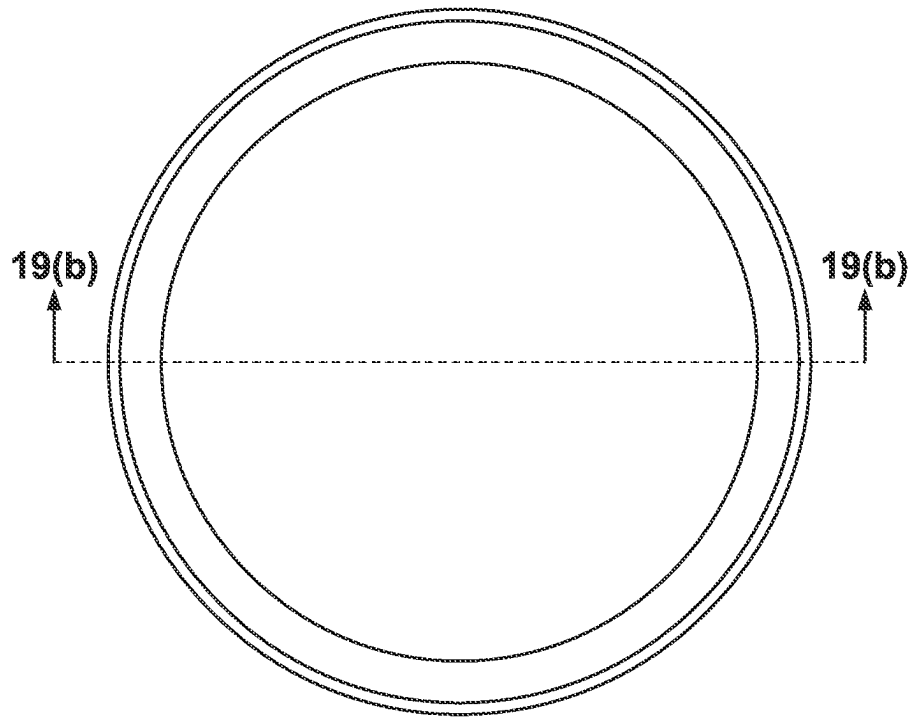


FIG. 19(a)

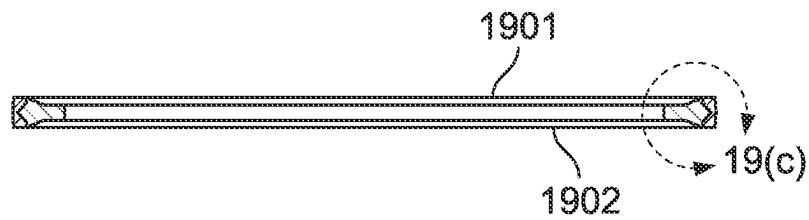


FIG. 19(b)

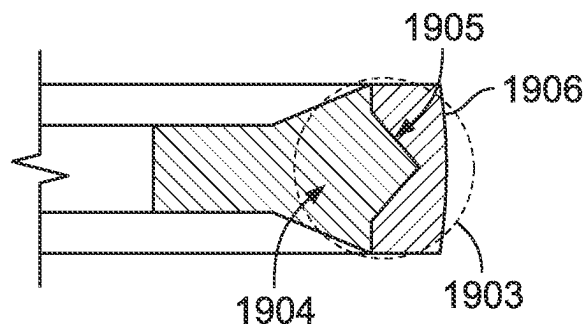


FIG. 19(c)

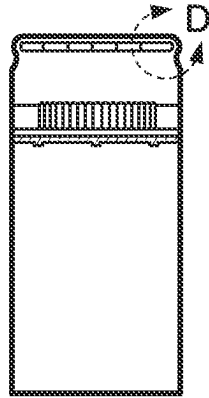


FIG. 20(a)

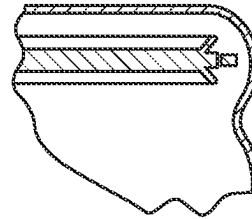


FIG. 20(b)

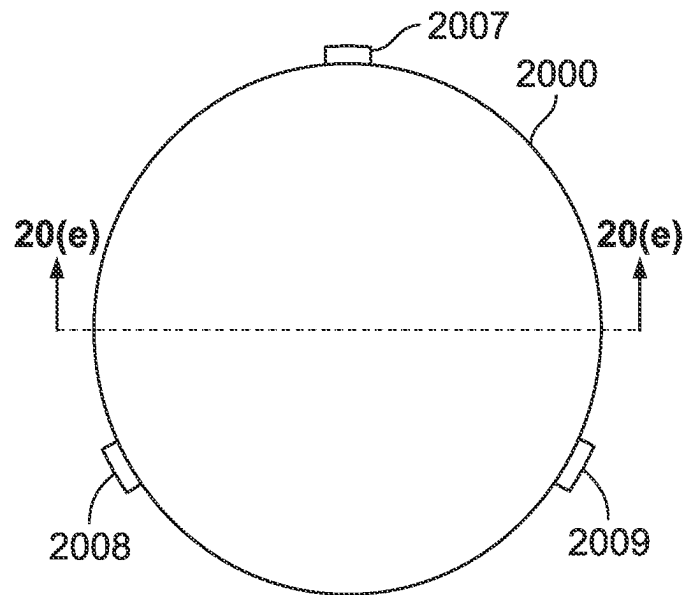


FIG. 20(c)

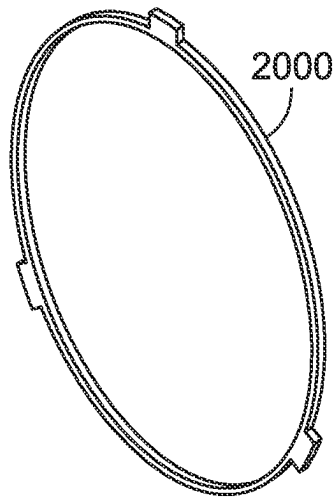


FIG. 20(d)

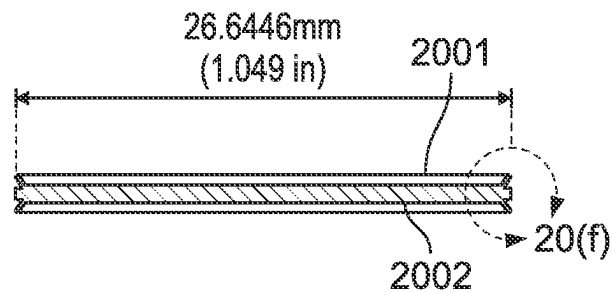


FIG. 20(e)

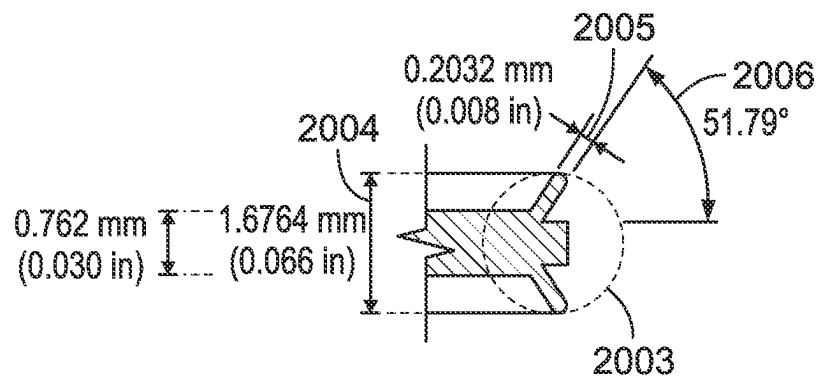


FIG. 20(f)

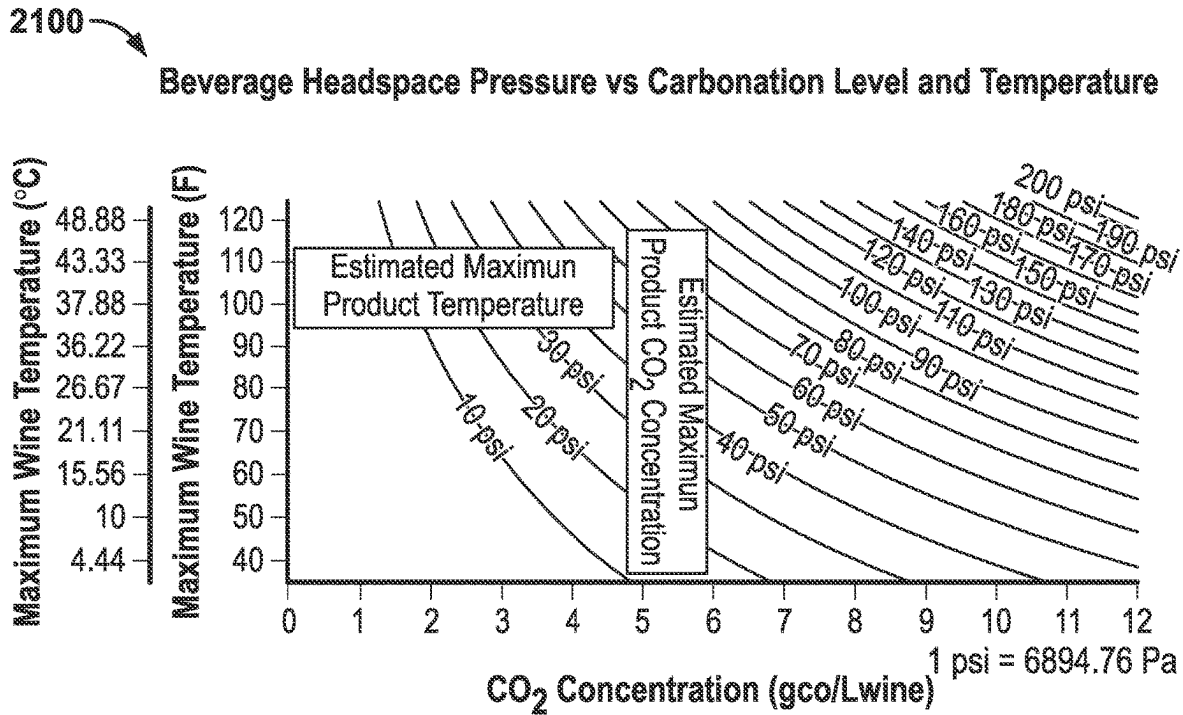


FIG. 21

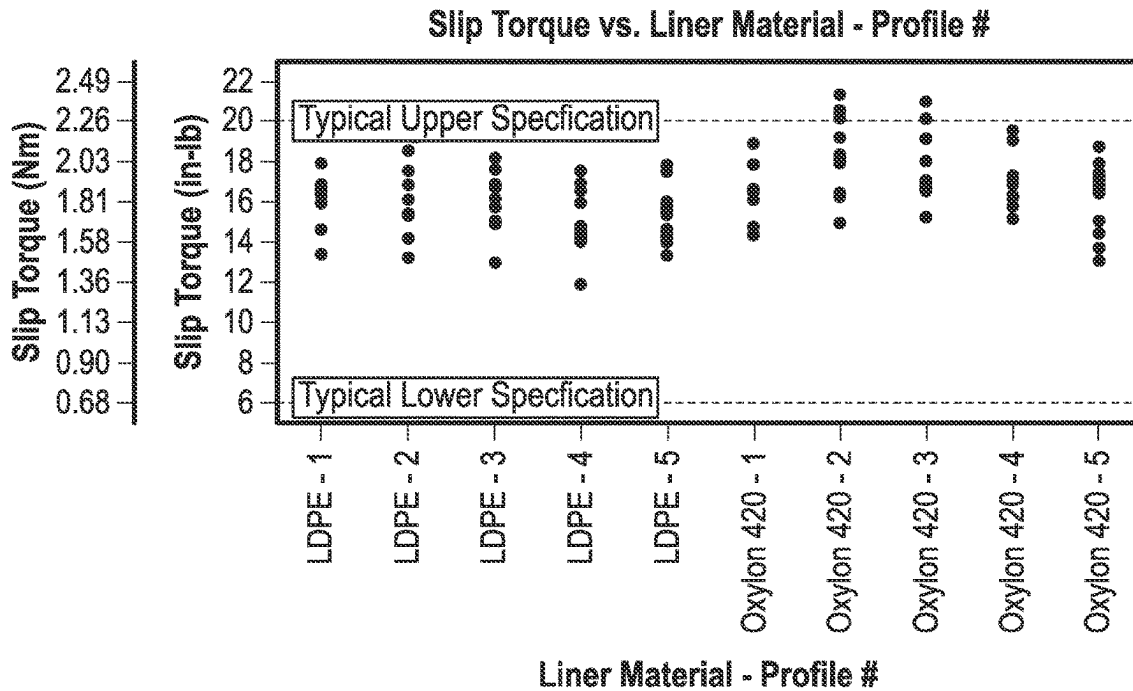


FIG. 22

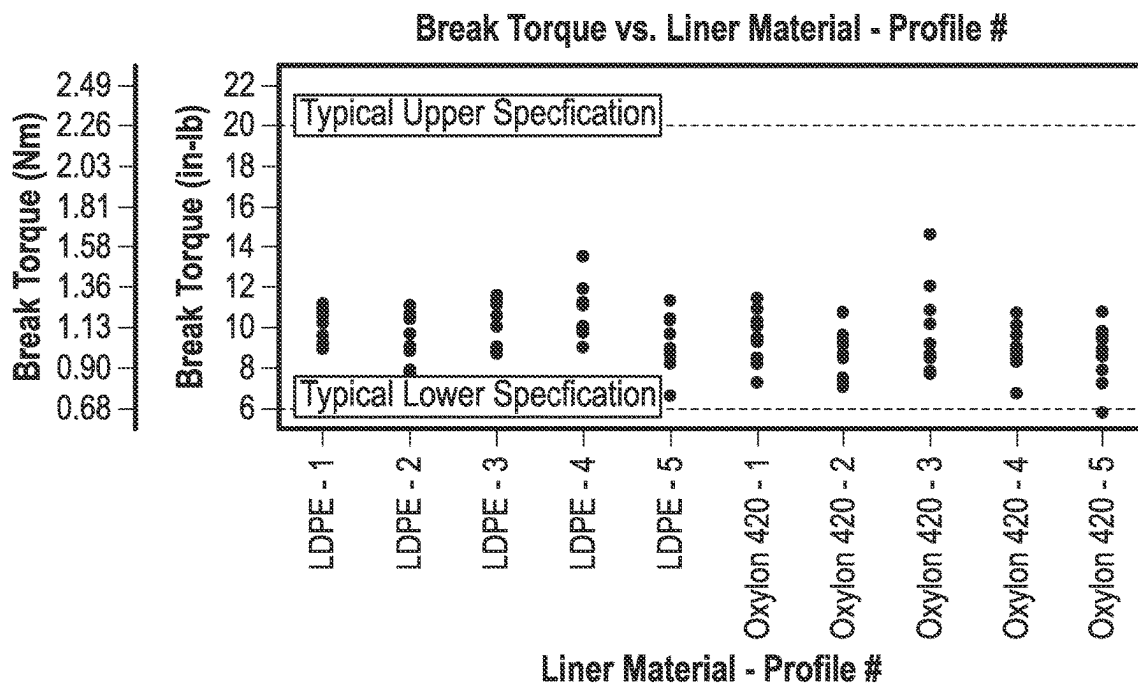


FIG. 23

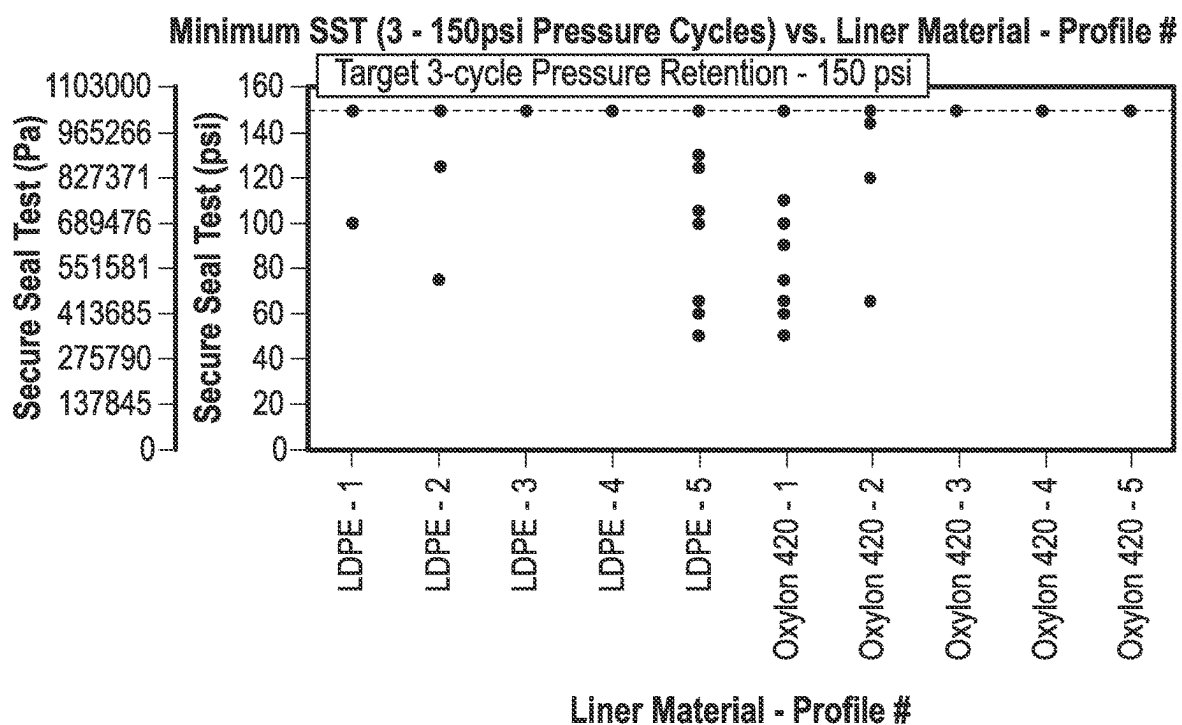


FIG. 24

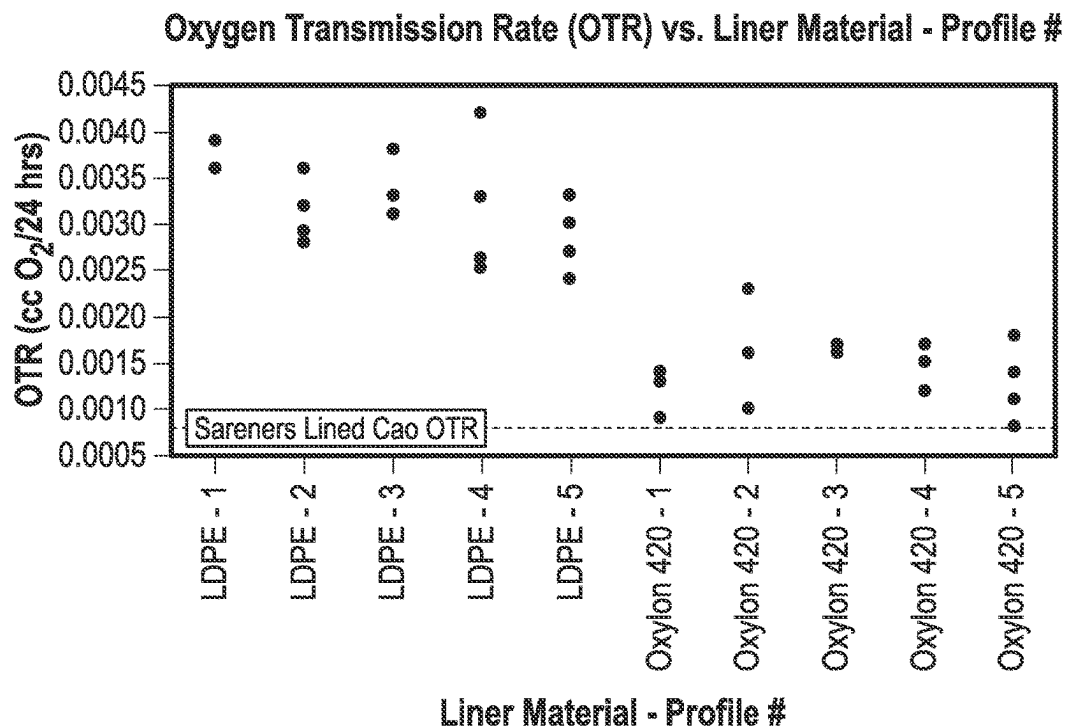


FIG. 25

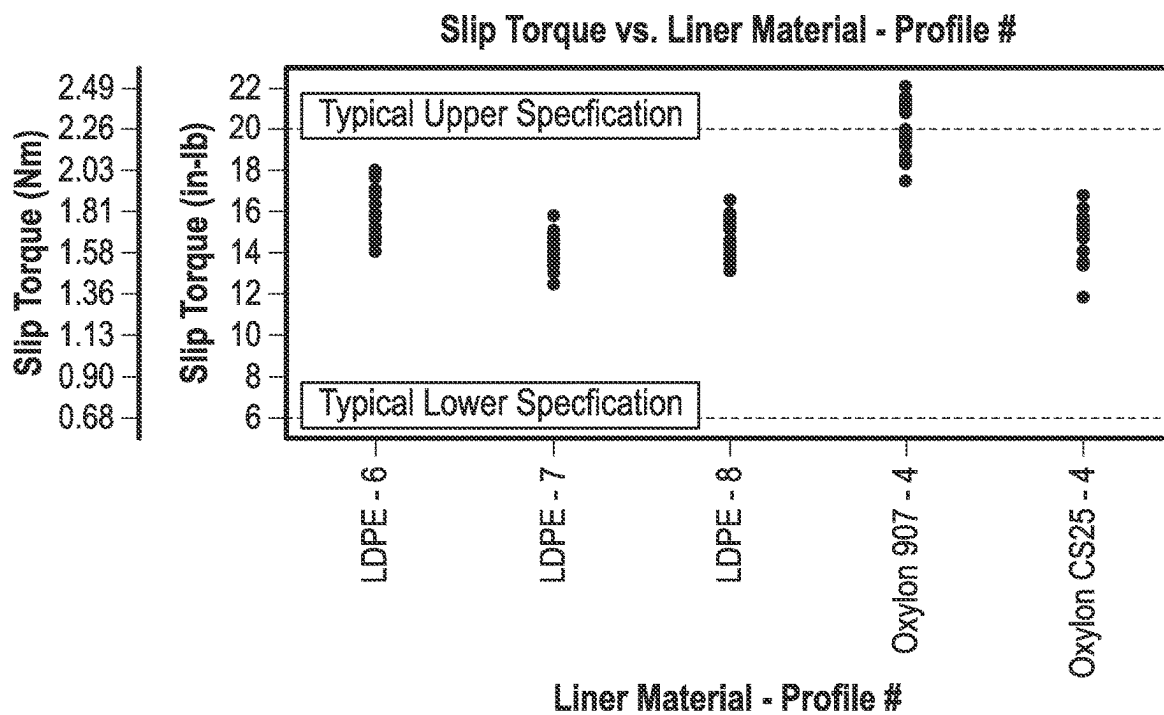


FIG. 26

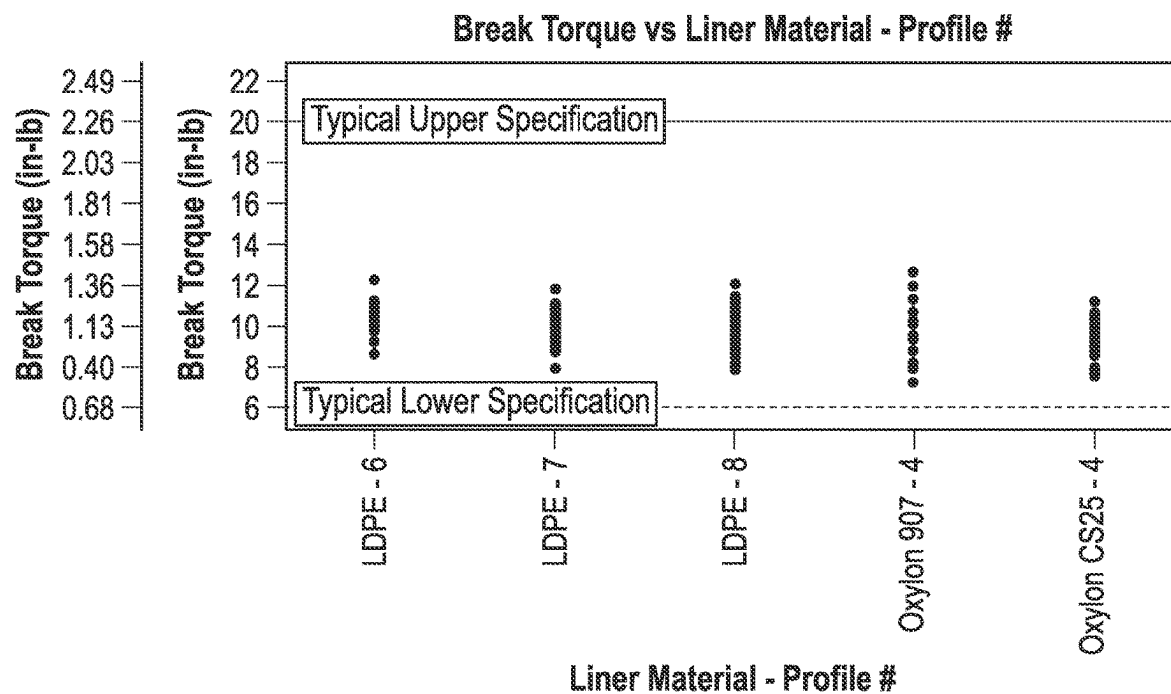


FIG. 27

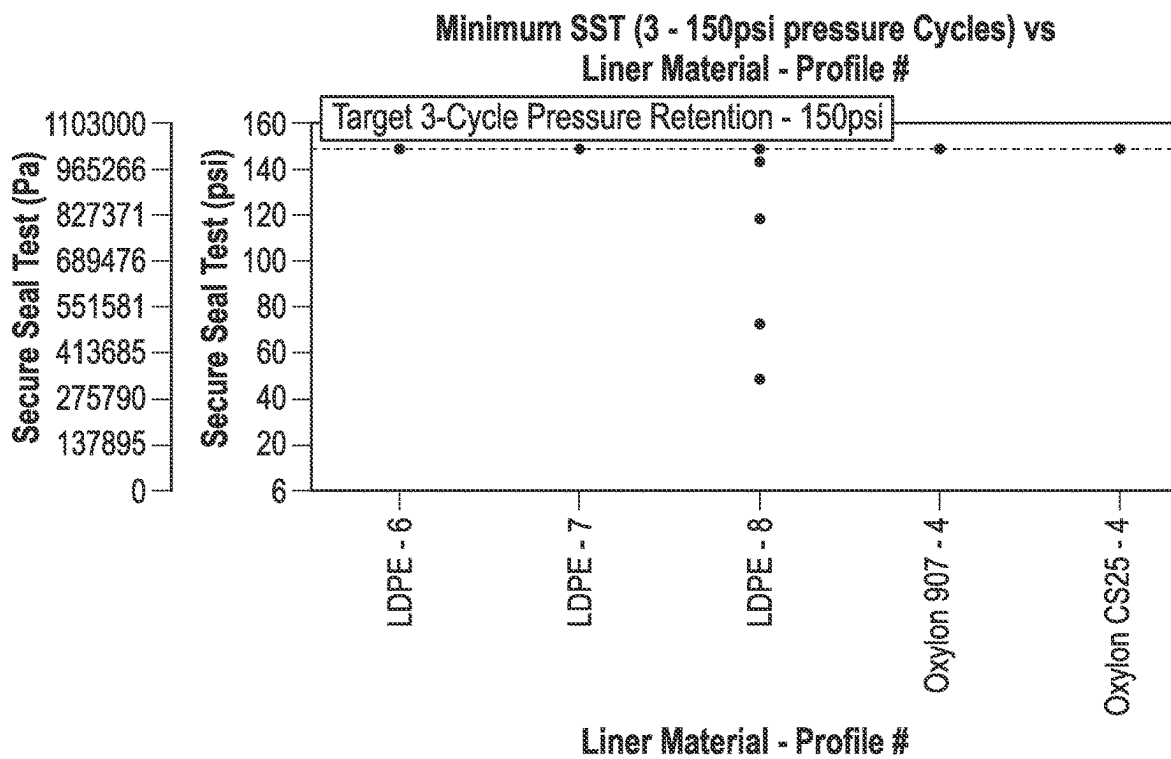


FIG. 28

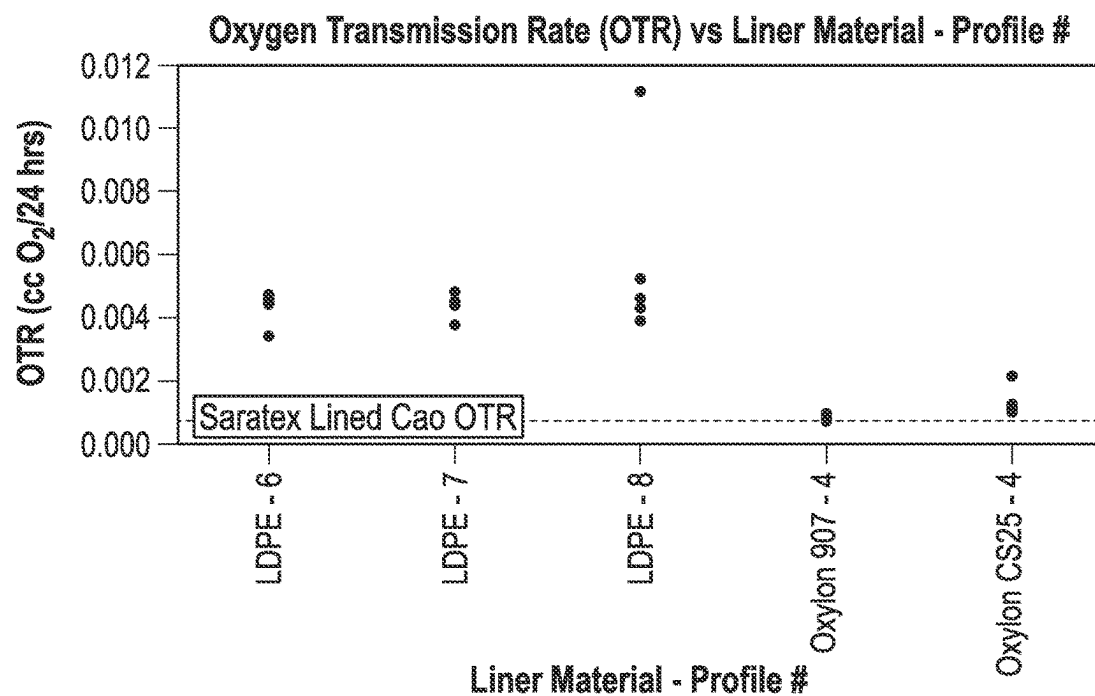


FIG. 29

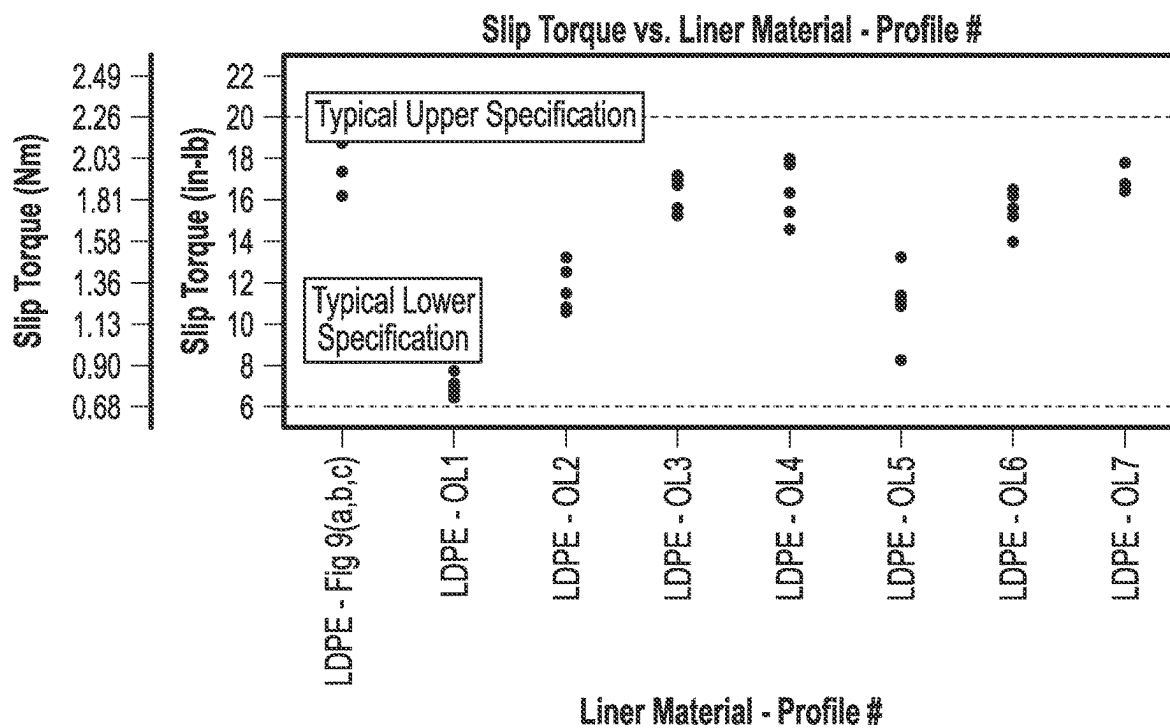


FIG. 30

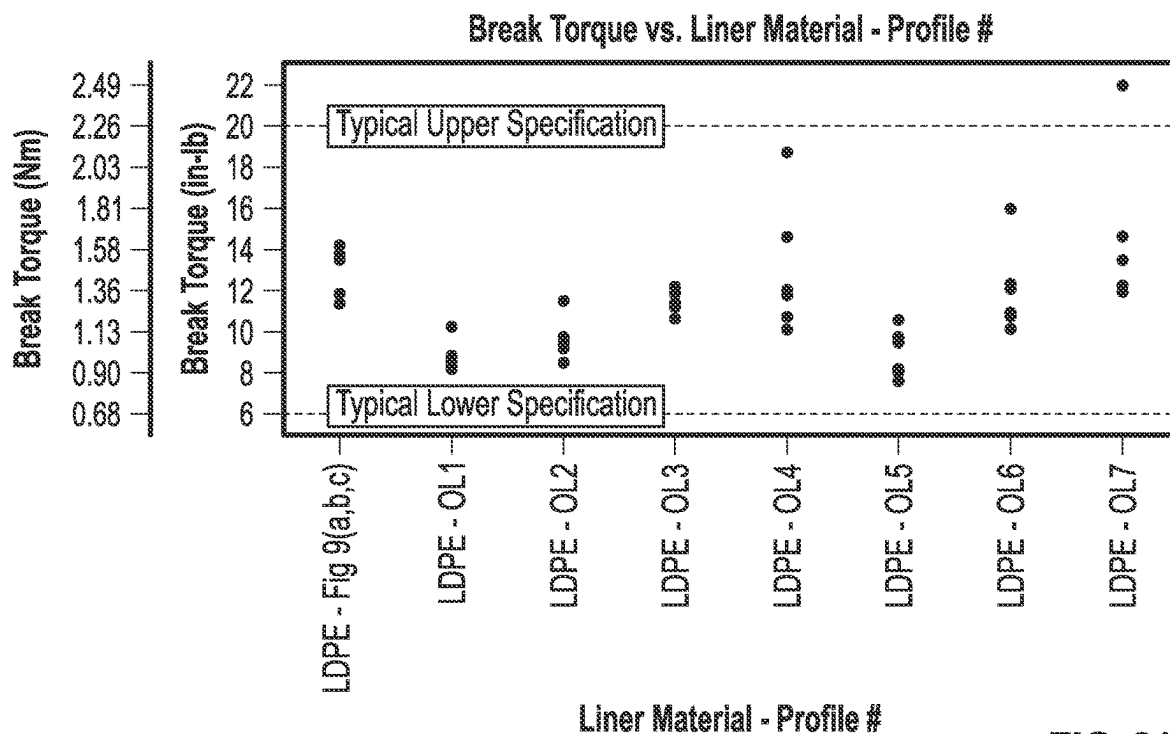


FIG. 31

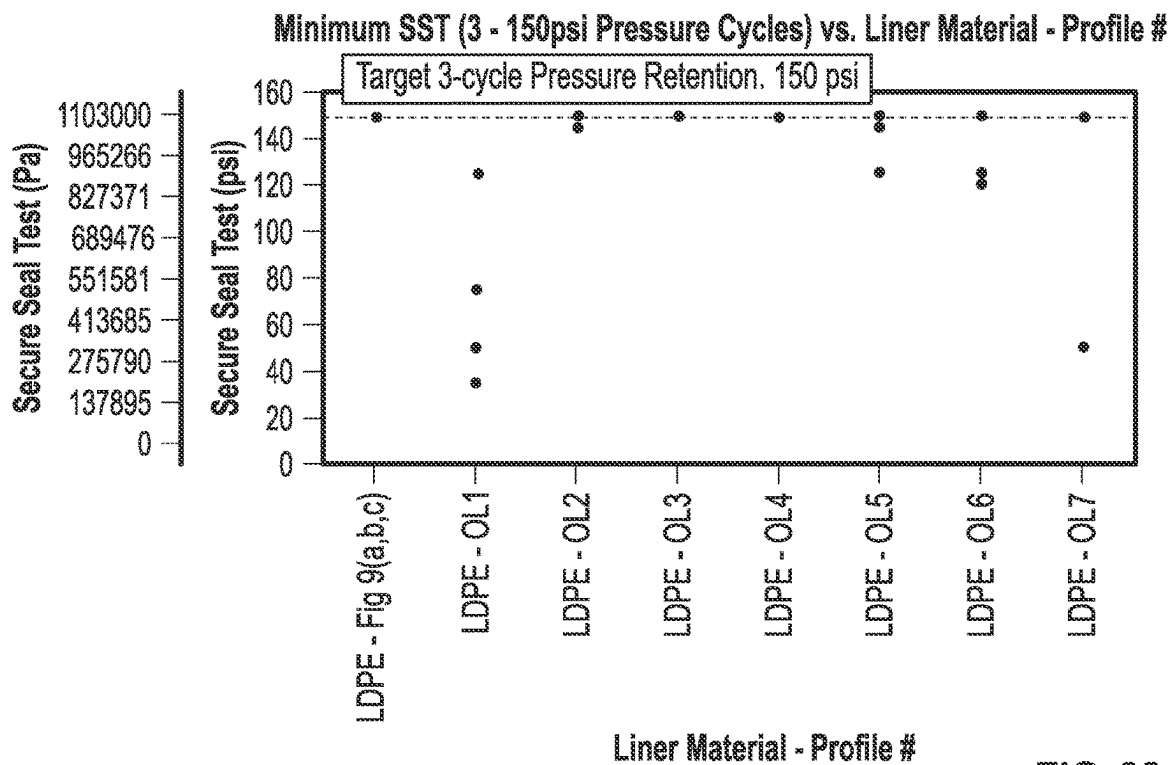


FIG. 32

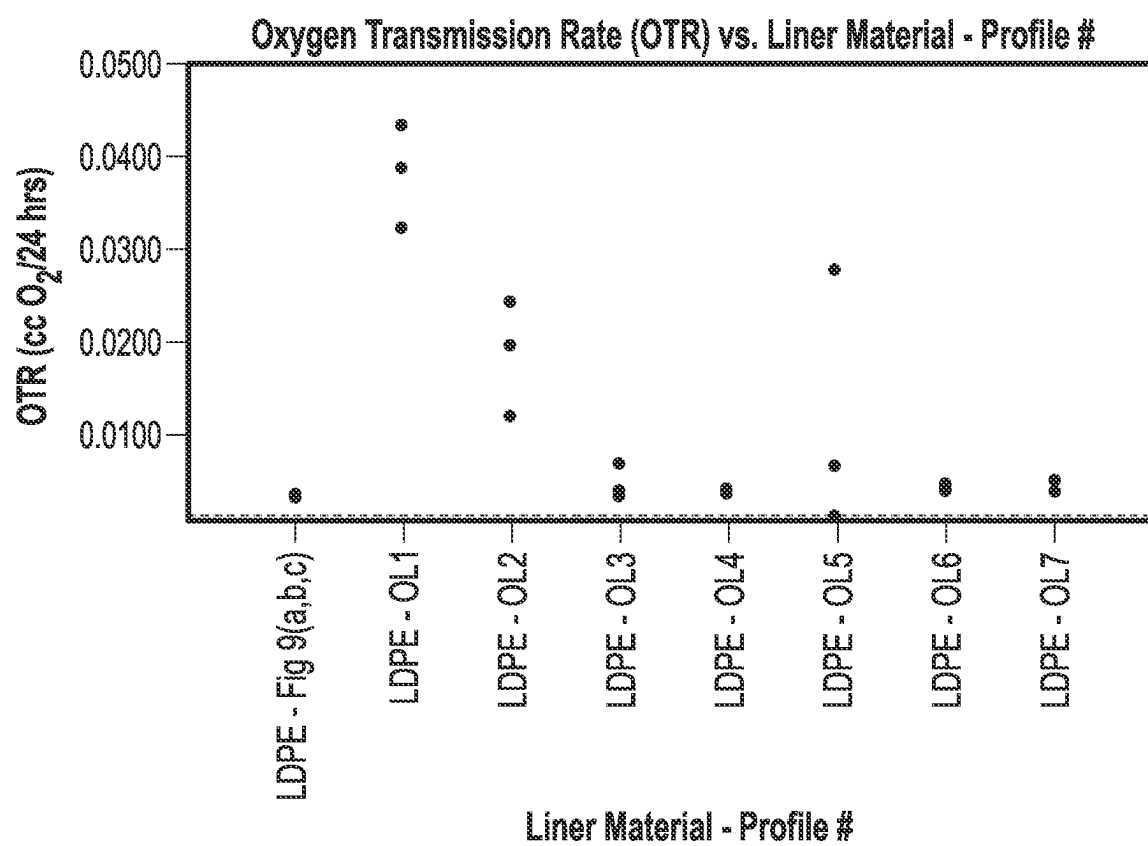


FIG. 33

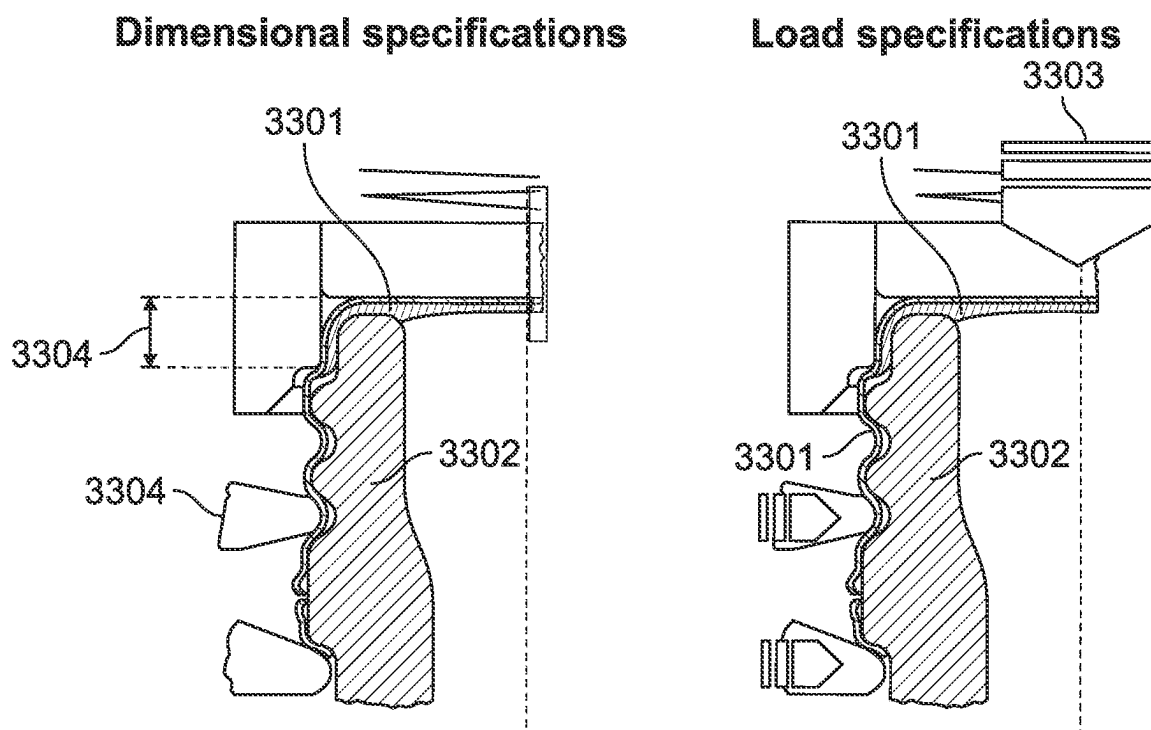


FIG. 34

OXYLON[®] 420 VP 1176452 white PFT**PHYSICAL AND CHEMICAL PROPERTIES**

Form	: granular
Colour	: white
Odour	: slight
pH	: not applicable
Melting Point	: not determined
Flash point	: > 100°C at 1.013 hPa Method: not determined
Vapour pressure	: no data available
Density	: ca. 0,9 g/cm ³ at 20 °C (1.013 hPa)
Bulk density	: ca. 0,5 kg/m ³ at 1.013 hPa
Water solubility	: negligible
Viscosity, kinematic	: not applicable
Viscosity, dynamic	: not applicable
Surface tension	: not determined
Auto-flammability	: not auto-flammable
Partition coefficient: n-octanol/water	: no data available

FIG. 35

Preliminary Technical Datasheet	
Oxylon® 420 VP 1176452 white PFT	
<i>Material:</i>	TPE - granulate, development product
<i>Intended use:</i>	TPE - sealing compound for aluminium closures
<i>Physical properties:</i>	
Shore Hardness A (ASTM D 2240-97, 5 mm)	94
Shore Hardness D (ASTM D 2240-97, 5 mm)	37
Melt flow Index (ISO 1133:1997, 5,00kg, 190°C)	31
<i>Colour:</i>	white
<i>Regulatory information:</i>	The raw materials comply with the FDA and / or BfR or EU recommendations or regulations.
<i>Storage conditions:</i>	Store away from direct sunlight, heat of more than 40°C (100°F), humidity and odours.
<i>Please note:</i>	The information provided herein is valid until three months after issue.

FIG. 36

OXYLON[®] 907 VP 1176454 white**PHYSICAL AND CHEMICAL PROPERTIES**

Form	: granular
Colour	: white
Odour	: slight
pH	: not applicable
Melting Point	: not determined
Flash point	: > 100°C at 1.013 hPa Method: not determined
Vapour pressure	: no data available
Density	: ca. 0,9 g/cm ³ at 20 °C (1.013 hPa)
Bulk density	: ca. 0,5 kg/m ³ at 1.013 hPa
Water solubility	: negligible
Viscosity, kinematic	: not applicable
Viscosity, dynamic	: not applicable
Surface tension	: not determined
Auto-flammability	: not auto-flammable
Partition coefficient: n-octanol/water	: no data available

FIG. 37

Preliminary Technical Datasheet	
Oxylon® 907 VP 130104 white	
<i>Material:</i>	TPE - granulate, development product
<i>Intended use:</i>	TPE - sealing compound for aluminium closures
<i>Physical properties:</i>	
Shore Hardness A (ASTM D 2240-97, 5 mm)	94
Shore Hardness D (ASTM D 2240-97, 5 mm)	36
Melt flow Index (ISO 1133:1997, 5,00kg, 190°C)	20
<i>Colour:</i>	white
<i>Regulatory Information:</i>	The raw materials comply with the FDA and / or BfR or EU recommendations or regulations.
<i>Storage conditions:</i>	Store away from direct sunlight, heat of more than 40°C (100°F), humidity and odours.
<i>Please note:</i>	The information provided herein is valid until 6 months after issue.

FIG. 38

OXYLON[®] CS 25 white**PHYSICAL AND CHEMICAL PROPERTIES**

Form	: granular
Colour	: white
Odour	: slight
pH	: not applicable
Melting Point	: not determined
Flash point	: > 100°C at 1.013 hPa Method: not determined
Vapour pressure	: no data available
Density	: ca. 0,9 g/cm ³ at 20 °C (1.013 hPa)
Bulk density	: ca. 0,5 kg/m ³ at 1.013 hPa
Water solubility	: negligible
Viscosity, kinematic	: not applicable
Viscosity, dynamic	: not applicable
Surface tension	: not determined
Auto-flammability	: not auto-flammable
Partition coefficient: n-octanol/water	: no data available

FIG. 39

Preliminary Technical Datasheet	
Oxylon® CS 25 VP 130105 white	
<i>Material:</i>	TPE - granulate, development product
<i>Intended use:</i>	TPE - sealing compound for aluminiumcaps
<i>Physical properties:</i>	
Shore Hardness D (ASTM D 2240-97, 5 mm)	48
Melt flow Index (ISO 1133:1997, 5,00kg, 190°C)	18
<i>Colour:</i>	white
<i>Regulatory Information:</i>	The raw materials comply with the FDA and / or BfR or EU recommendations or regulations.
<i>Storage conditions:</i>	Store away from direct sunlight, heat of more than 40°C (100°F), humidity and odours.
<i>Please note:</i>	The information provided herein is valid until three months after issue.

FIG. 40

SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR IMPLEMENTING CAP CLOSURE FOR CARBONATED AND OXYGEN SENSITIVE BEVERAGES

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

The present application for patent claims the benefit of and priority to and is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/066,252, filed Oct. 8, 2020, entitled "System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages," which claims the benefit of and priority to and is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 14/608,016, filed Jan. 28, 2015, entitled "System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated and Oxygen Sensitive Beverages," which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/932,701, filed on Jan. 28, 2014, entitled "System and Method for Implementing Cap Closure for Carbonated Wine," the entire contents of each of which are herein incorporated by reference.

FIELD

The present disclosure relates in general to cap closures. In particular, the present disclosure relates to a system and method for implementing cap closure for carbonated and oxygen sensitive beverages such as wine.

BACKGROUND

A number of wineries offer lower alcohol (e.g. 9%), lightly sweet, semi-sparkling wines. These semi-sparkling wines are marketed and promoted to consumers as casual and approachable wines that are ideal for outdoor get-togethers with family and friends. Semi-sparkling wine contains a significant level of carbon dioxide that gives its fizzy appearance and effervescent mouth feel. The pressure in a bottle of semi-sparkling wine typically varies from approximately 0.3 to 2 atmospheres which equates to concentrations of 2 to 5 g CO₂/L at 20° C.

There are four main issues when applying traditional wine closures for these semi-sparkling wines: brand image, ease of opening, re-sealability, and pressure retention. Champagne corks with wire hoods are too formal. Crown closures have a more relaxed image, but are not easy to open. Additionally, both champagne corks and crown closures are not designed to be easily reapplied to the package by the consumer. Long-skirt screw-caps (e.g. 30 mm diameter×60 mm tall aluminum closures with traditional SARANEX™ liners) provide the right marketing image and are easy to re-apply. However, lab tests show that these long-skirt screw-caps containing SARANEX liners cannot consistently retain an internal pressure greater than 40 psi within a bottle of semi-sparkling wine. Such internal pressures in these semi-sparkling wines can be reached under typical shipping and storage conditions.

There are several injection molded liner technologies commercially available for carbonated wine such as GUALA® MOSS and ERBEN® ASTRO. These liners are specifically designed for carbonated products and are typically used in 30×60 mm aluminum screw-caps. These liners are made of a low-density polyethylene material resulting in relatively low material costs but comparatively high oxygen transmission rates (OTR) of 0.003 cc O₂/closure/24 hours.

SUMMARY

A system and method for implementing cap closure for a carbonated beverage is disclosed. According to one embodiment, an apparatus includes a cap liner having a circular ring shape. The apparatus further comprises an outer lip and an inner portion of the circular ring shape. The outer lip is wider than the inner portion, and the outer lip has two or more members extending away from a center of the outer lip.

The above and other preferred features, including various novel details of implementation and combination of elements, will now be more particularly described with reference to the accompanying figures and pointed out in the claims. It will be understood that the particular systems and methods described herein are shown by way of illustration only and not as limitations. As will be understood by those skilled in the art, the principles and features described herein may be employed in various and numerous embodiments.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

The accompanying figures, which are included as part of the present specification, illustrate the various embodiments of the present disclosed system and method and together with the general description given above and the detailed description of the preferred embodiments given below serve to explain and teach the principles of the present disclosure.

FIG. 1(a) illustrates a top view of an exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 1(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of an exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 1(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 1(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of an exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 1(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 2(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 2(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 2(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 2(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 2(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 3(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 3(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 3(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 3(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 3(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 4(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 4(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 4(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 4(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 4(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 5(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 5(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 5(a), according to one embodiment.

3

FIG. 5(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 5(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 6(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 6(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 6(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 6(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 6(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 7(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 7(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 7(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 7(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 7(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 8(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 8(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 8(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 8(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 8(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 9(a) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 9(b) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap as illustrated in FIG. 9(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 9(c) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 9(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 9(d) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 9(c), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 9(e) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 9(d), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 10(a) illustrates a detailed cross-section of an outer lip diagram showing how outer lip designs were made to conduct a design-of-experiment on liner outer lip structures, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 10(b) illustrates a design-of-experiment array created to determine the effect of various structural elements on the liner performance characteristics, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 11(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 11(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 11(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 11(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 11(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 12(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 12(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 12(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 12(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 12(b), according to one embodiment.

4

FIG. 13(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 13(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 13(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 13(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 13(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 14(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 14(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 14(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 14(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 14(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 15(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 15(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 15(a) according to one embodiment.

FIG. 15(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 15(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 16(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 16(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 16(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 16(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 16(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 17(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 17(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 17(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 17(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 17(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 18(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 18(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 18(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 18(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 18(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 19(a) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 19(b) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 19(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 19(c) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 19(b), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 20(a) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 20(b) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap as illustrated in FIG. 20(a), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 20(c) illustrates a top view of another exemplary cap liner according to one embodiment.

FIG. 20(d) illustrates a 3-dimensional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 20(c), according to one embodiment.

5

FIG. 20(e) illustrates a cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 20(c), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 20(f) illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. 20(e), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 21 illustrates an exemplary graph for determining a maximum internal package pressure in a rigid container filled to the appropriate volume, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 22 illustrates an exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on slip torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 23 illustrates an exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on break torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 24 illustrates an exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on secure seal test (SST), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 25 illustrates an exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on oxygen transmission rate (OTR), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 26 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on slip torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 27 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on break torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 28 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on secure seal test (SST), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 29 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on oxygen transmission rate (OTR), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 30 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on slip torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 31 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on break torque, according to one embodiment.

FIG. 32 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on secure seal test (SST), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 33 illustrates another exemplary plot of the effect of various types of cap liners on oxygen transmission rate (OTR), according to one embodiment.

FIG. 34 illustrates an exemplary diagram of cap settings that are adjusted for the proper application of a cap closure to a bottle, according to one embodiment.

FIGS. 35-36 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® 420 liner material, according to one embodiment.

FIGS. 37-38 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® 907 liner material, according to one embodiment.

FIGS. 39-40 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® CS25 liner material, according to one embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

A system and method for implementing cap closure for a carbonated beverage is disclosed. According to one embodiment, an apparatus includes a cap liner having a circular ring shape. The apparatus further comprises an outer lip and an inner portion of the circular ring shape. The outer lip is wider

6

than the inner portion, and the outer lip has two or more members extending away from a center of the outer lip.

Each of the features and teachings disclosed herein can be utilized separately or in conjunction with other features and teachings to provide a system and method for implementing cap closure for carbonated and oxygen sensitive wine. Representative examples utilizing many of these additional features and teachings, both separately and in combination, are described in further detail with reference to the attached figures. This detailed description is merely intended to teach a person of skill in the art further details for practicing preferred aspects of the present teachings and is not intended to limit the scope of the claims. Therefore, combinations of features disclosed above in the detailed description may not be necessary to practice the teachings in the broadest sense, and are instead taught merely to describe particularly representative examples of the present teachings.

In the description below, for purposes of explanation only, specific nomenclature is set forth to provide a thorough understanding of the present disclosure. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that these specific details are not required to practice the teachings of the present disclosure.

Moreover, the various features of the representative examples and the dependent claims may be combined in ways that are not specifically and explicitly enumerated in order to provide additional useful embodiments of the present teachings. It is also expressly noted that all value ranges or indications of groups of entities disclose every possible intermediate value or intermediate entity for the purpose of original disclosure, as well as for the purpose of restricting the claimed subject matter. It is also expressly noted that the dimensions and the shapes of the components shown in the figures are designed to help to understand how the present teachings are practiced, but not intended to limit the dimensions and the shapes shown in the examples.

According to one embodiment, the present system and method provides a cap liner configuration that is formed using injection molding for an aluminum 30 mm diameter by 60 mm tall (30x60) screw-cap closure. The present liner configuration is determined using a design-of-experiment (DOE) methodology.

The present system and method provides a cap (e.g., an aluminum screw-cap) that includes a cap liner with a specified liner profile. The present cap provides a sealing performance that is controlled largely based on its liner characteristics including the liner's components and the liner's physical profile. The present system and method provides a cap liner that seals sufficiently to prevent the beverage from leaking out of the package. The present system and method further provides a cap liner that controls the transmission of oxygen from the air outside the package into the product. The amount of oxygen allowed into the package along with the rate of oxygen transmission can have a significant impact on the beverage's nutritional content, flavor and mouth feel. Liner types have traditionally been chosen by cap manufacturers (e.g., G3) with a focus on ease of use, performance, and price. According to one embodiment, the present cap liner provides an OTR value close to that of a SARANEX™ lined cap (0.0008 cc O₂/24 hours) and holds an internal package pressure greater than 70 psi.

FIGS. 1(a)-1(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of an exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner 100 is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 millimeters (mm). The cap liner 100

7

includes two circular-shaped cavities **101** and **102** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **100**. The two circular-shaped cavities **101** and **102** create an inner ring **105** ("inner rib"), within the cap liner **100**. The inner ring **105** has an inner rib height **107** of 1.00 mm created by the depression of either circular-shaped cavity **101** and **102**.

The cap liner **100** further includes two ring-shaped troughs **103** and **104** that are located outside the two circular-shaped cavities **101** and **102** and inside the outer circumference of the cap liner **100**. Each ring-shaped trough **103** and **104** is depressed into both sides of the cap liner **100**. The base of the ring for each ring-shaped trough **103** and **104** is 5.00 mm wide. The two ring-shaped troughs **103** and **104** create an outer ring ("outer lip") **106** directly adjacent to the circumference of the cap liner **100**. Each ring-shaped trough **103** and **104** is depressed at a height of 0.50 mm relative to the cap liner **100** trough's base and outer ring peak. The outer ring **106** has an overall outer lip height **108** of 1.75 mm and an outer lip angle **109** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **106** further includes an outer nub **110** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. 2(a)-2(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **200** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **200** includes two circular-shaped cavities **201** and **202** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **200**. The two circular-shaped cavities **201** and **202** create an inner ring **205** ("inner rib") within the cap liner **200**. The inner ring **205** has an inner rib height **207** of 1.00 mm created by the depression of either circular-shaped cavity **201** and **202**.

The cap liner **200** further includes two ring-shaped troughs **203** and **204** that are located outside the two circular-shaped cavities **201** and **202** and inside the outer circumference of the cap liner **200**. Each ring-shaped trough **203** and **204** is depressed into both sides of the cap liner **200**. The base of the ring for each ring-shaped trough **203** and **204** is 5.00 mm wide. The two ring-shaped troughs **203** and **204** create an outer ring **206** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to the circumference of the cap liner **200**. Each ring-shaped trough **203** and **204** is depressed at a height of 0.25 mm relative to the cap liner **200** trough's base and outer ring peak. The outer ring **206** has an overall outer lip height **208** of 1.25 mm and an outer lip angle **209** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **206** further includes an outer nub **210** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. 3(a)-3(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **300** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **300** includes two circular-shaped cavities **301** and **302** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **300**. The two circular-shaped cavities **301** and **302** create an inner ring **305** ("inner rib") within the cap liner **300**. The inner ring **305** has an inner rib height **307** of 0.50 mm created by the depression of either circular-shaped cavity **301** and **302**.

The cap liner **300** further includes two ring-shaped troughs **303** and **304** that are located outside the two circular-shaped cavities **301** and **302** and inside the outer circumference of the cap liner **300**. Each ring-shaped trough **303** and **304** is depressed into both sides of the cap liner **300**. The base of the ring for each ring-shaped trough **303** and **304** is 5.00 mm wide. The two ring-shaped troughs **303** and **304**

8

create an outer ring **306** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to the circumference of the cap liner **300**. Each ring-shaped trough **303** and **304** is depressed at a height of 0.50 mm relative to the cap liner **300** trough's base and outer ring peak. The outer ring **306** has an overall outer lip height **308** of 1.75 mm and an outer lip angle **309** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **306** further includes an outer nub **310** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. 4(a)-4(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **400** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **400** includes two circular-shaped cavities **401** and **402** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **400**. Each circular-shaped cavity **401** and **402** has a base diameter of 25.75 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **401** and **402** create an outer ring **403** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **400**. The outer lip **403** has a height **405** of 1.51 mm and an outer lip angle **406** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **403** further includes an outer nub **404** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. 5(a)-5(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **500** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **500** includes two circular-shaped cavities **501** and **502** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **500**. Each circular-shaped cavity **501** and **502** has a base diameter of 25.75 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **501** and **502** create an outer ring **503** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **500**. The outer lip **503** has a height **505** of 1.25 mm and an outer lip angle **506** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **503** further includes an outer nub **504** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. 6(a)-6(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **600** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **600** includes two circular-shaped cavities **601** and **602** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **600**. Each circular-shaped cavity **601** and **602** has a base diameter of 25.75 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **601** and **602** create an outer ring **603** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **600**. The outer lip **603** has a height **605** of 1.75 mm and an outer lip angle **606** of 22° 15'. The outer ring **603** further includes an outer nub **604** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap. The cap liner **600** has a similar liner profile to the cap liner **400** but with a modified outer lip height **605**.

FIGS. 7(a)-7(c) illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **700** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **700** includes two circular-shaped cavities **701** and **702** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **700**. Each circular-shaped cavity **701** and **702** has a diameter of 25.75 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **701** and **702** create an outer ring **703** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **700**. The outer lip **703** has a height **705** of 1.63 mm and

an outer lip angle **706** of $22^{\circ} 15'$. The outer ring **703** further includes an outer nub **704** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap. The cap liner **700** has a similar liner profile to the cap liner **400** but with a modified outer lip height **705**.

FIGS. **8(a)-8(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **800** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.84 mm. The cap liner **800** includes two circular-shaped cavities **801** and **802** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **800**. Each circular-shaped cavity **801** and **802** has a diameter of 26.73 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **801** and **802** create an outer ring **803** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **800**. The outer lip **803** has a height **805** of 1.63 mm and an outer lip angle **806** of $37^{\circ} 15'$. The outer ring **803** further includes an outer nub **804** designed to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap. The cap liner **800** has a similar liner profile to the cap liner **400** but with a modified outer lip height **805** and a modified outer lip angle **806**.

FIGS. **9(a)-9(b)** illustrate a cross-sectional view and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap as, according to one embodiment. FIGS. **9(c)-9(e)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. **9(b)**, designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **900** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 28.44 mm. The cap liner **900** includes two circular-shaped cavities **901** and **902** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **900**. Each circular-shaped cavity **901** and **902** has a diameter of 25.75 mm. The two circular-shaped cavities **901** and **902** create an outer ring **903** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **900**. The outer lip **903** has a height **905** of 1.63 mm. The cap liner **900** does not include an outer nub allowing the cap liner **900** to be more easily inserted into an aluminum cap shell while still maintaining enough of an interference fit to keep it solidly retained in the finished cap.

FIG. **10(a)** illustrates a detailed cross-sectional view of an “outer lip” **1000** of cap liners for a design-of experiment. FIG. **10(a)** further illustrates in details a thickness **1001** of the outer lip structure **1000**, an outer lip angle **1002** measured with respect to a reference line (“datum”) and a diameter **1003** of the outer lip structure **1000** measured from a baseline relative to the other liners in the study.

FIG. **10(b)** illustrates an exemplary table **1004** of the outer lip samples used in a test, according to one embodiment. The table **1004** illustrates the outer lip angle (“lip structure angle”) **1002** measured with respect to a reference line (“datum”), the thickness **1001** of the outer lip structure (“lip structure thickness”) and the diameter **1003** of the outer lip measured relative to the liners in the study, for seven different liner outer lip profiles used in the test. FIGS. **11-17** illustrate these seven test samples in detail.

FIGS. **11(a)-11(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1100** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1100** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1101** and **1102** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1100**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1101** and **1102** create an outer ring

1103 (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1100**. The outer lip **1103** has an overall height **1104** of 0.062 in, lip structure thickness **1105** of 0.012 in and an outer lip angle of 0° .

FIGS. **12(a)-12(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1200** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1200** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1201** and **1202** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1200**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1201** and **1202** create an outer ring **1203** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1200**. The outer lip **1203** has an overall height **1204** of 0.062 in, lip structure thickness **1205** of 0.016 in and an outer lip angle of 0° .

FIGS. **13(a)-13(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1300** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1300** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1301** and **1302** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1300**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1301** and **1302** create an outer ring **1303** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1300**. The outer lip **1303** has an overall height **1304** of 0.063 in, lip structure thickness **1305** of 0.008 in and an outer lip angle **1306** of 140° .

FIGS. **14(a)-14(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1400** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1400** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1401** and **1402** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1400**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1401** and **1402** create an outer ring **1403** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1400**. The outer lip **1403** has a height **1404** of 0.066 in, thickness **1405** of 0.012 in and an outer lip angle **1406** of 70° . Due to the outer diameter reduction of this liner, created by the designed experiment’s factor levels, an outer “nub” **1407** was added to the outer lip **1403** to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. **15(a)-15(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1500** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1500** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1501** and **1502** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1500**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1501** and **1502** create an outer ring **1503** (“outer lip”) directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1500**. The outer lip **1503** has an overall height **1504** of 0.066 in, lip structure thickness **1505** of 0.008 in and an outer lip angle **1506** of 35° . Due to the outer diameter reduction of this liner, created by the designed experiment’s factor levels, an outer “nub” **1507** was added to the outer lip **1503** to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. **16(a)-16(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1600** is of a circular disc shape

11

with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1600** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1601** and **1602** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1600**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1601** and **1602** create an outer ring **1603** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1600**. The outer lip **1603** has an overall height **1604** of 0.065 in, lip structure thickness **1605** of 0.016 in and an outer lip angle **1606** of 105°. Due to the outer diameter reduction of this liner, created by the designed experiment's factor levels, an outer "nub" **1607** was added to the outer lip **1603** to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. **17(a)**-**17(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1700** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1700** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1701** and **1702** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1700**. The two circular-shaped cavities **1701** and **1702** create an outer ring **1703** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1700**. The outer lip **1703** has an overall height **1704** of 0.063 in, lip structure thickness **1705** of 0.012 in and an outer lip angle **1706** of 140°. Due to the outer diameter reduction of this liner, created by the designed experiment's factor levels, an outer "nub" **1707** was added to the outer lip **1703** to help retain the liner in the aluminum screw cap.

FIGS. **18(a)**-**18(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **1800** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap liner **1800** includes two circular-shaped cavities **1801** and **1802** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1800**. Each circular-shaped cavity **1801** and **1802** has a diameter of 1.010 in. The two circular-shaped cavities **1801** and **1802** create an outer ring **1803** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1800**. The outer lip **1803** has a height **1804** of 0.061 in and an outer lip angle **1805** of 22.25°. Dual injection molding technique is used to create the outer lip **1803** or portions thereof with a different material than the remainder of the liner. For example, low density polyethylene (LDPE) may be used to create the inner portions of the liner **1800**, and thermoplastic elastomers (TPE) may be over-molded to the LDPE to form the liner's outer edge including the entire outer lip **1803** or just portions of the outer lip. The thickness of the over-molded TPE material can vary during the molding process depending on the amount of TPE required to obtain the desired effect. For example, as shown in FIG. **18(b)**, the thickness of the over-molded portion **1807** on the outside edge of the liner **1800** can be 0.018 in, 0.039 in, 0.069 in cross-sectional width or the like, depending on the amount of TPE desired in the final liner design. The cap liner **1800** does not include an outer nub allowing the cap liner **1800** to be more easily inserted into an aluminum cap shell while still maintaining enough of an interference fit to keep it solidly retained in the finished cap.

FIGS. **19(a)**-**19(c)** illustrate respectively a top view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. In this exemplary embodiment, the cap liner's **1900** center is removed to save material and therefore reduce the manufacturing cost. The cap liner **1900** is consequently of a circular ring shape with a diameter of 1.120 in. The cap

12

liner **1900** includes two annular surfaces **1901** and **1902**. The annular surfaces **1901** and **1902** are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **1900** ring and create an outer lip **1903** directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **1900**.

The outer lip **1903** includes an inner portion **1904** and an outer portion **1905**. Dual injection molding technique is used to create the annular surfaces **1901** and **1902** and an over-mold **1906** creating the outer portion **1905** of the outer lip **1903**. The material used to create the outer portion of the outer lip **1905** may encroach on the inner portion of the outer lip **1904** depending on the liner's functional requirements. Low density polyethylene (LDPE), polypropylene (PP), or any material providing the appropriate properties, such as rigidity, is used for inner portion **1904** of the outer lip **1903** formed by the annular surfaces **1901** and **1902**, and a thermoplastic elastomer (TPE), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), high-density polyethylene (HDPE), polyamide or other material providing appropriate properties, such as reduced oxygen transmission, is used for the over-mold **1906** portion of the cap liner **1900** including all or some of the outer lip **1903**. The outer lip **1903** may be shaped as necessary to provide for the proper performance characteristics. The triangular shape of the outer lip **1903** is designed to help to provide a larger surface area and a better LDPE to TPE adhesive strength to maintain the liner's integrity.

FIGS. **20(a)**-**20(b)** illustrate a cross-sectional view and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner in a screw cap as, according to one embodiment. FIGS. **20(c)**-**20(f)** illustrate respectively a top view, a 3-dimensional view, a cross-sectional view, and a detailed cross-sectional view of another exemplary cap liner as illustrated in FIG. **20(b)**, designed for use in a 30 mm diameter aluminum top-side seal closure, according to one embodiment. The cap liner **2000** is of a circular disc shape with a diameter of 1.049 in. The cap liner **2000** includes two circular-shaped cavities **2001** and **2002** that are each depressed into both sides of the cap liner **2000**. The two circular-shaped cavities **2001** and **2002** create an outer ring **2003** ("outer lip") directly adjacent to a circumference of the cap liner **2000**. The outer lip **2003** has a height **2004** of 0.066 in, thickness **2005** of 0.008 in and an outer lip angle **2006** of 51.79°. The outer lip **2003** further includes three tabs **2007**, **2008**, **2009**, that are created by removing extra material from the outer lip **2003** nub to help reduce the amount of material and cost. The three tabs **2007**, **2008**, **2009** provide enough of an interference fit to keep the liner solidly retained in the finished cap.

FIG. **21** illustrates an exemplary graph for determining a maximum internal package pressure in a rigid container filled to the appropriate volume, according to one embodiment. A plot **2100** illustrates that for a maximum wine temperature of about 110° F. and a carbon dioxide concentration in the beverage of about 5.4 gram/liter, the expected maximum product pressure is 70 psi.

FIGS. **22**-**25** illustrate exemplary plots of the effect of various types of cap liners on slip torque, break torque, secure seal test (SST), and oxygen transmission rate (OTR) respectively, according to one embodiment. In particular, FIGS. **22**-**25** illustrate plots of the effect of the cap liner's material and physical profiles LDPE-1, LDPE-2, LDPE-3, LDPE-4, LDPE-5, Oxyton 420-1, Oxyton 420-2, Oxyton 420-3, Oxyton 420-4, Oxyton 420-5 on slip torque, break torque, SST, and OTR, respectively.

Referring to FIG. **22**, the slip torque distributions for cap liners made of a TPE called OXYLON® 420 (e.g., Oxyton 420-3, Oxyton 420-4, and Oxyton 420-5) indicate higher slip torques than the cap liners made of a LDPE liner

material (e.g., LDPE-1, LDPE-2, LDPE-3, LDPE-4, and LDPE-5). According to one embodiment, adjustments to the slip torque can be made by using a slip agent. The slip agent can be based upon any of a number of materials approved for food contact that are added to the liner material of a liner profile to reduce slip torque. These slip agents include, but are not limited to, amides, erucamide, oleamide, polyethylene beads, lanolin, and carnauba waxes.

Referring to FIG. 23, the break torque scatter plots for cap liners made of an OXYLON® liner material (e.g., Oxylon 420-3, Oxylon 420-4, and Oxylon 420-5) indicate only slight differences when compared with the cap liners made of a LDPE liner material (e.g., LDPE-1, LDPE-2, LDPE-3, LDPE-4, and LDPE-5).

Further, referring to FIG. 24, the cap liners made of an OXYLON® 420 liner material (Oxylon 420-3, Oxylon 420-4, and Oxylon 420-5) and cap liners made of LDPE (LDPE-3, and LDPE-4) performed well in the SST test by holding the targeted minimum SST of 150 psi for each of 3 pressure cycles. However, the cap liners made of an OXYLON® 420 liner material (Oxylon 420-1, and Oxylon 420-2) and a LDPE liner material (LDPE-1, LDPE-2, and LDPE-5) did not hold pressure well with scatter plots showing a number of the samples leaking below the targeted minimum SST of 150 psi.

Referring to FIG. 25, the OTR values for the cap liners made of OXYLON® 420 liner material (Oxylon 420-1, Oxylon 420-2, Oxylon 420-3, Oxylon 420-4, and Oxylon 420-5) are lower than the OTR values for the cap liners made of a LDPE liner material (LDPE-1, LDPE-2, LDPE-3, LDPE-4, and LDPE-5). In particular, the OTR for the cap liners made of an OXYLON® 420 liner material is about half of the OTR for the cap liners made of an LDPE liner material.

A cap liner profile is selected based on a targeted slip and a targeted SST. For example, the targeted slip is 6-20 in-lbs., and the targeted SST is a minimum of 150 psi. Referring to FIGS. 22 and 24, the cap liner LDPE-4 provides the best results for a targeted slip of 10-20 in-lbs. and a targeted minimum SST of 150 psi. The cap liner LDPE-3 provides subsequent closest results for the targeted slip and the targeted SST, followed by the cap liner LDPE-2.

FIGS. 26-29 illustrate exemplary plots of slip torque, break torque, SST, and OTR test results for various cap liners respectively, according to one embodiment. In particular, FIGS. 26-29 illustrate plots of slip torque test results, break torque test results, SST test results, and OTR test results respectively for the cap liners LDPE-6, LDPE-7, LDPE-8, Oxylon 907-4 and Oxylon CS25-4.

According to one embodiment, a slip agent chosen from a number of materials approved for food contact are added to the liner material of a liner profile to reduce slip torque. These slip agents include, but are not limited to, amides, erucamide, oleamide, polyethylene beads, lanolin, and carnauba waxes.

Referring to FIG. 26 and FIG. 28, the cap liner made of LDPE-7 liner material has a lowest average slip torque of 14.08 in-lbs. and an average SST of 150 psi. Referring to FIG. 29, the average OTR of the cap liner LDPE-8 is the highest compared to the average OTR of the other cap liners LDPE-6 and LDPE-7. These liners LDPE-6, LDPE-7, LDPE-8 are all made using the same LDPE material and differ only in their physical profile.

Referring to FIG. 26, the cap liner made of using OXYLON® CS25 liner material (Oxylon CS25-4) has a lower average slip than the cap liner made of an OXYLON® 907 liner material (Oxylon 907-4). However, both Oxylon

CS25-4 and Oxylon 907-4 have the same average SST of 150 psi, as illustrated in FIG. 28. Oxylon 907-4 has a lower OTR than Oxylon CS25-4, as illustrated in FIG. 29. These liners Oxylon 907-4, Oxylon CS25-4 are made using the same physical profile and differ only in the TPE materials.

FIGS. 30-33 illustrate exemplary plots of slip torque, break torque, SST, and OTR test results for various cap liners respectively, according to one embodiment. In particular, FIGS. 30-33 illustrate plots of slip torque test results, break torque test results, SST test results, and OTR test results respectively for the cap liners made of, LDPE used for the exemplary embodiments of FIGS. 9(a)-9(c), LDPE-OL1, LDPE-OL2, LDPE-OL3, LDPE-OL4, LDPE-OL5, LDPE-OL6 and LDPE-OL7.

According to one embodiment, a slip agent chosen from a number of materials approved for food contact are added to the liner material of a liner profile to reduce slip torque. These slip agents include, but are not limited to, amides, erucamide, oleamide, polyethylene beads, lanolin, and carnauba waxes.

Referring to FIG. 30, the cap liner made of LDPE-OL1 liner material has a lowest average slip torque of approximately 7 in-lbs. However, referring to FIG. 32, the cap liners having specific profiles LDPE-FIG. 9(a)(b)(c) and LDPE-OL3 all held an average SST pressure of 150 psi. Referring to FIG. 33, the average OTR of the cap liner LDPE-OL1 is the highest compared to the average OTR of the other cap liners LDPE-FIG. 9(a)(b)(c), LDPE-OL2, LDPE-OL3, LDPE-OL4, LDPE-OL5, LDPE-OL6 and LDPE-OL7. All liners LDPE-FIG. 9(a)(b)(c), LDPE-OL1, LDPE-OL2, LDPE-OL3, LDPE-OL4, LDPE-OL5, LDPE-OL6 and LDPE-OL7 were made using the same LDPE material and differed only in their physical profiles.

According to one embodiment, each cap liner sample is manually inserted into a 30×60 mm aluminum screw cap and applied to a wine bottle. (U.S. standard-GPI finish 1680). The wine bottle may contain any type of liquid, such as water or lightly carbonated wine. In one embodiment, each wine bottle is pressurized to a desired level to a mimic a desired carbon dioxide level (e.g., 2-4 g CO₂/L) within the wine bottle. Each cap closure may be applied to a desired bottle finish using any capper equipment known in the art.

According to one embodiment, the capper settings used to apply each cap closure containing each liner Oxylon 420-1, Oxylon 420-2, Oxylon 420-3, Oxylon 420-4, Oxylon 420-5, LDPE-1, LDPE-2, LDPE-3, LDPE-4, LDPE-5 are: a top load of 450 lbf; a reform depth of 0.070 inches; a thread roller force of 28 lbf; a pilfer roller force of 20 lbf; thread and pilfer roller heights are set to proper gage.

According to another embodiment, the capper setting used to apply each cap closure containing each liner profile Oxylon 907-4, Oxylon CS25-4, LDPE-6, LDPE-7, LDPE-8, are: a top load of 400 lbf; a reform depth of 0.074 inches, a thread roller force of 28 lbf; a pilfer roller force of 25 lbf; and roller heights are set to proper gage.

FIG. 34 illustrates an exemplary diagram of capper settings used to apply a cap closure to a bottle, according to one embodiment. A top load 3303 refers to an amount of force that is applied to the top of a cap metal 3301 to compress the cap liner within the cap metal 3301 onto a bottle's sealing surface 3302. A reform depth 3304 refers to a depth that the cap metal 3301 is forced tight over the bottle's seal surface 3302. A thread roller 3304 pushes on a side of the cap metal 3301 to apply a thread roller force which forms threads in the cap metal 3301 during application.

According to one embodiment, the cap liner samples are allowed to sit for a minimum of 24 hours prior to testing.

15

Each cap liner sample is evaluated for pressure retention using a SECUREPAK® (a type of package testing instrument) Secure Seal Tester by pressurizing each sample's headspace to 150 psi, holding the pressure of each sample at 150 psi for 5-10 seconds and then releasing the pressure to 0 psi. This pressurization is repeated three times for each sample, with the maximum pressure (psi) held being recorded. In another embodiment, each cap liner sample is evaluated for oxygen transmission rate (OTR) to determine the rate at which oxygen permeates through each cap liner. The cap liner samples are allowed to equilibrate for a minimum of three days on an equilibration rack, transferred to the MOCON® OX-TRAN® 2121 testing stations and tested a minimum of three times or until the steady-state OTR is reached.

Competitive cap products (ERBEN® ASTRO and GUALA® MOSS) contain injection molded liners with inner ribs. Competitors claim this inner rib helps the package retain pressure generated by the carbonated beverage. In particular, the ERBEN® ASTRO liner is patented in Italy by Strocco et al. (Patent No. 0001378221 entitled "Plastic Gasket with a Pressure Seal for Closing Bottles or Similar Containers") and contains references to the inner rib as being integral to the liner's sealing characteristics. However, the results of the present DOE modeling illustrates that the present liner profile does not require an inner rib to increase the ability of the liner to seal. In particular, the present liner profile does not include an inner rib since the sealing performance of the liner is based on configuration of the outer lip and the material used to create the outer lip.

According to one embodiment, the present cap liner profiles are injection molded, single-layered liners made from either an LDPE liner material or a TPE liner material that provides superior oxygen barrier properties. The TPE liner material may include, but not limited to, OXYLON® 420, OXYLON® 907, and OXYLON® CS25 manufactured by ACTEGA® (a company that manufactures coatings and sealants).

According to another embodiment, the present cap liner profiles are dual-injection molded, double-layered liners made from an LDPE liner material and a TPE liner material that provides superior oxygen barrier properties. The TPE liner material may include, but not limited to, OXYLON® 420, OXYLON® 907, and OXYLON® CS25 manufactured by ACTEGA® (a company that manufactures coatings and sealants).

FIGS. 35-36 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® 420 liner material, according to one embodiment. FIGS. 37-38 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® 907 liner material, according to one embodiment. FIGS. 39-40 illustrate exemplary physical and chemical properties of OXYLON® CS25 liner material, according to one embodiment.

The above example embodiments have been described hereinabove to illustrate various embodiments of providing a system and method for implementing cap closure for carbonated wine. Various modifications and departures from the disclosed example embodiments will occur to those having ordinary skill in the art. The subject matter that is intended to be within the scope of the disclosure is set forth in the following claims.

We claim:

1. An apparatus, comprising:

a cap liner comprising:

an outer lip, wherein a cross-section of the outer lip comprises a single upper extension member and a single lower extension member;

16

an inner portion surrounded by the outer lip and comprising a substantially uniform thickness; and a protuberant outer nub projecting radially outward from the outer lip and defining an outer perimeter of the cap liner,

wherein the cap liner is symmetric about a symmetry plane centered within the substantially uniform thickness of the inner portion,

wherein a maximum thickness of the protuberant outer nub in a direction perpendicular to the symmetry plane is less than the substantially uniform thickness of the inner portion, and

wherein a cross-section of the protuberant outer nub has a convex outer surface that is rounded outward, wherein the outer lip comprises a substantially flat outer edge extending between top and bottom surfaces of the outer lip,

wherein the protuberant outer nub projects radially outward from the substantially flat outer edge and is substantially centered between the between top and bottom surfaces of the outer lip without extending to the top and bottom surfaces of the outer lip.

2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the inner portion comprises a ring shape or a disc shape.

3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the maximum thickness of the protuberant outer nub is approximately equal to a radial length of the nub.

4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the upper extension member and the lower extension member each defines an outer lip angle from about 35° to about 140°.

5. The apparatus of claim 4, wherein the outer lip angle is about 70°.

6. The apparatus of claim 4, wherein the outer lip angle is about 140°.

7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the inner portion comprises an inner ring.

8. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the outer lip comprises a height from about 1.25 mm to about 1.75 mm.

9. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the inner portion is substantially planar.

10. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the outer lip is taller than the inner portion.

11. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the inner portion is made of a solid material that extends to a center of the cap liner from the outer lip.

12. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the inner portion defines a first circular shaped cavity on an upper side and a second circular shaped cavity on a lower side.

13. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein at least one of the outer lip or the inner portion is injection molded, dual injection molded, or over-molded.

14. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein at least one of the outer lip or the inner portion is made of low-density polyethylene (LDPE) or thermoplastic elastomer (TPE).

15. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the cap liner comprises a slip agent comprising one or more of an amide, an erucamide, an oleamide, polyethylene beads, a lanolin, or carnauba wax, and wherein the slip agent provides a friction factor that allows a cap of a beverage container to be opened using human force.

16. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the cap liner defines a central opening and is ring shaped.

17. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a cap closure containing the cap liner.

17

18

18. The apparatus of claim **17**, further comprising a bottle, wherein the cap closure is disposed over an opening in the bottle.

* * * * *